A Crumbling Empire: Part 1

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/59431228.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Catra & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra), Angella & Glimmer (She-Ra), Mermista & Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Adora & Light Hope (She-Ra), Hordak & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Adora & Hordak (She-Ra), Catra & Scorpia (She-Ra)

Characters:
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Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Alternate Universe - Adora Remains with the Horde (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting (She-Ra), Angst, Trans Adora (She-Ra), Trans Female Character, Angst and Tragedy, War, Catra Has Issues (She-Ra), Adora Has Issues (She-Ra), Trauma, Eventual Smut

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A Crumbling Empire: Part 1

by LaLloyd271, OppositionAgent

Summary

After Adora finds a mysterious sword in the Whispering Woods, she and Catra venture out to find some answers. What they find instead is that not only is Adora a princess, she's the most powerful one of all: She-Ra, Princess of Power. The Brightmoon Rebellion's days are numbered with this new power being used for the Horde.

Notes

This universe is based on my one of my one-shots. I won't link it here since it's definitely not for everyone, but it's the next part of this series so you can easily find it if you want. It does contain "spoilers" for what comes next.

For those worried that I won't be completing this series, don't worry! I have already written the entirety of this part and I will be uploading the new chapters on a (somewhat) normal schedule. Part 2 and 3 are in the works and I'm very excited to write them. Stay tuned for more angst and gay women.

Editing credit goes to my partner, LaLloyd271. Most of this was written by me, OppositionAgent, but they did a little bit of the actual writing.

The Sword

Chapter Summary

> Adora goes back for the sword, but takes Catra with her. Shenanigans ensue.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora didn't usually dream, and she didn't think they should cause this much distress. Dreams were supposed to be pleasant, that's what Catra said at least. But now because of a dream, she woke up in the middle of the night, something she had never done before, and something she surely would be punished for if she got caught.

Adora noticed Catra sleeping peacefully at the end of her bed and smiled. Catra was so beautiful like this, so peaceful. Adora couldn't let Catra be punished along with her for this, and she had to find the sword again.

Why do I keep seeing the sword? Adora thought. *What's so important about it, and who is that purple lady?*

Carefully, Adora stepped out of bed and got dressed for the outing. She crept out of the sleeping quarters and into the long, winding hallways of the Horde barracks.

"Hey, where are you going?" Catra appeared suddenly behind Adora, causing her freeze for a split second.

"Back to the woods," Adora said. "There's something I need to figure out."

"What? You're not-"

Adora clasped her hand to Catra's mouth and dragged them both behind a pillar as a security bot rolled by.

"What's wrong with you?" Catra slapped Adora's hand away and stepped back. "You've been acting weird since we got back. Are you sure you're not brain damaged?"

"Look, Catra, I know I saw something out there," Adora said. "It's ju- I just need to get another look. It feels important somehow."

"Sounds good. Let's go."

"No. I don't want you getting in trouble on my behalf," Adora said. "Just cover for me okay? I'll be back before anyone knows I'm gone."

"No." Catra grabbed Adora's wrist. "We don't know what's out there, I need to protect you."

"Catra…" Adora said.

"I'm coming with you," Catra said. "You can't stop me."

"Okay."

They had been wandering in the woods for what felt like hours. Catra was a notorious complainer, but even Adora was nearing her limit.

"You know, I did tell you not to come," Adora chuckled.

"Shut up!" Catra playfully shoved her. "You never would have made it this far without me and you know it."

"Yeah right," Adora laughed. "We haven't run into anything but weird trees. What are they going to do, stand menacingly at me?"

“Whatever.”

Adora knocked Catra with her shoulder. “You know I’m right.”

“You’re not right about everything, you know,” Catra said. “I’ve saved your skin more times than you can count.” She leapt forward and tackled Adora.

Adora fell to the ground laughing. “Yeah, I know,” she said. “Get off me!” She pushed Catra away.

“Ugh, rude!” Catra scoffed sarcastically. “Hey, is that it?”

Adora turned her head to see what Catra was looking at. A faint blue glow was shining near them behind a group of twisted trees. “Yeah, I think it is,” Adora said breathlessly. *This is finally it*, she thought. *The place where I find answers*.

Adora and Catra got up and walked toward the light source together. They stood before a clearing, in the middle was a glowing sword, the same sword Adora had seen before, propped up by a twisted mess of roots.

“Woah,” Catra said, her sarcastic tone dropping for just a moment. “Do I have brain damage too?”

“I dou-” Adora started.

“Horde soldiers!”

“Huh?” Adora and Catra turned toward the sound of the voice. A young man and woman were standing on the opposite edge of the clearing, shouting and standing in intimidating stances.

“Rebels,” Catra said. “You get the sword, I’ll hold them off!”

Adora sprinted toward the sword. She felt someone grab her heels and she fell over face-first onto the dirt. She looked over her shoulder, surprised that the woman had gotten behind her without her noticing and grabbed her. Adora kicked at her face and she

loosened her grip. Adora shook herself loose and scrambled back to her feet. Adora saw Catra swiping her claws at the man; he held a bow and was using it to try to block Catra's attacks.

Adora started running for the sword again, but she felt a sudden impact on her back and fell to the ground, catching herself this time.

"We're not letting you get the First Ones' tech!" the woman shouted, as she ran past Adora.

First Ones? Adora thought. *What the hell is that?*

Adora reached out and grabbed the woman's ankle. She began to fall to the ground, but disappeared in a puff of pink sparkles before she hit the ground.

"What the fuck?" Adora said. Then she realized. "Catra, they're princesses!"

The woman reappeared next to the sword, grabbing it with both hands.

"Argh!" Catra turned her focus to the woman and lunged for her, but she disappeared again in another pink, glittery puff.

"Catra!" Adora shouted, as she crashed into the tangled roots.

"Bow, let's get out of here!" the woman reappeared next to the man, whose name was Bow, apparently, and they started running out of the clearing.

"Not so fast." Adora pulled her knife out of her boot and reached for Bow. He tried to block her with his, well, bow, but Adora turned the block's momentum against him and finished the motion with a firm grip on Bow and her knife pressed to his neck. It wasn't enough to draw blood or anything; she had been taught never to kill a hostage unless absolutely necessary. "Give me the sword!"

“Glimmer, help,” Bow said, straining himself to not hurt his neck against Adora’s blade.

“I will *never* let the Horde get their hands on th-” Glimmer started, but Catra cut her off with a. surprise tackle, causing her to drop the sword.

Immediately, Adora threw Bow to the ground and dived for the sword. The second she touched it, it started glowing like it had when she touched it earlier. *Oh shit, not again*, she thought as her consciousness faded.

“Adora!” she faintly heard Catra shout.

“**Hello, Adora.**”

Adora was in some kind of dream again. Before her stood a purple, angular woman in a black void filled with bright white dots. Somehow, Adora knew they were called stars. “Who are you?” Adora asked. “What’s going on?”

“**My name is Light Hope,**” the woman said. “**I have been waiting a long time for you, but I could not reach you until you forged your connection with the sword.**”

“You sent the sword?”

“**The sword is meant for you,**” Light Hope said. “**Etheria has need of you, Adora. Will you answer its call? Will you fight for the honor of Grayskull?**”

“What are you talking about?” Adora was very confused. “What- what is- what's Grayskull? You're not making any sense! I don't understand!”

"**You will.**"

"Wait!" Adora reached out for Light Hope. A bright flash of light erupted around her as she felt herself begin to wake up.

Adora woke up feeling very groggy, like she had been sleeping for hours. She wanted to go back to sleep. *How could the ground be this comfortable?* She started to look around with dreary eyes and saw Catra still fighting Glimmer and Bow. Clearly, she had not been out for that long.

Catra was holding the sword, waving it frantically in front of her, seemingly to protect Adora. "Back away!" she shouted.

"Catra?" Adora said.

"You're finally awake, sleepyhead!" Catra said, looking over her shoulder for just a moment. "I've got the sword, let's go before I have to taste more glitter!"

Adora got to her feet. "Catra, give me the sword."

"What?" Catra said. "You passed out the last two times you did that, are you *really* sure you're not brain damaged?"

"I'm fine, just give it to me!" Adora reached for the sword. Catra pulled her hands away and Adora leaned further to grab it. "Catra, I know what I'm doing!"

Catra opened her mouth to retort, but she got cut off as they were both hit with one of Glimmer's magic blasts. She dropped the sword and Adora grabbed hold of it. Glimmer teleported next to Adora and grabbed the sword as well.

"Let go!" Adora shouted. "It's mine!"

"It belongs to Etheria!" Glimmer said. "The Horde can't have it."

What did that weird lady say? Adora thought. *What is it I'm supposed to fight for?* "This sword is mine!" she said. "It's meant for me!"

"How could you possibly believe that?" Glimmer said.

Will you fight for the honor of Grayskull? The strange woman's words rang in Adora's head. She knew what she had to do.

Adora yanked the sword away from Glimmer. "I'll show you, *princess*," she said, holding it high above her head. "*For the honor of Grayskull!*"

The same bright flash erupted from the sword as before, but Adora didn't feel herself losing consciousness again. If anything, she felt more awake than ever, more alert, as if she was being powered up by the sword. She could feel her body changing, like she was growing taller and her muscles were growing stronger. She could feel immense power coursing through her, a sensation that was somehow both alien and incredibly familiar, like the power had always been inside her. It was magical.

When the light faded, in a moment that seemed to both last an eternity and also just a split second, Adora recognized that she had indeed become taller. She seemed to tower over everyone in the clearing. They were all looking up with here in awe, and perhaps fear as well. Adora didn't know what she expected would happen when she used the sword, but this was close enough. What she didn't expect was what she saw when she looked at herself.

"What the fuck?" Why was she dressed like a princess? What did that purple lady do to her? Did she actually do this or did she do

this to herself? What the hell was this sword?

“Bow, we have to go,” Glimmer said.

“But the sword!”

“Do you want to fight fucking *She-Ra* for it?” Glimmer asked. “We have to go warn my mom.”

“She-Ra,” Bow said. “The legend *is* true.”

The two rebels quickly gathered themselves and scampered off into the woods, disappearing from Adora’s view. She turned to Catra, who was cowering from her in fear.

“Hey, it’s just me,” Adora said. “I don’t know what’s going on, but it’s going to be okay.”

“Get away from me!” Catra shouted. “I didn’t know being a princess was *contagious!*” She began to back into the trees.

“Catra, wait!” Adora dropped the sword; instantly, her new form disappeared and she was back to her old self. She fell to her knees. “Please!”

Catra paused at the end of the clearing. “Adora, what’s going on?”
“I don’t know!” Adora said. “I’ve been having these flashes of a strange woman, telling me that I have to save Etheria, that I have to fight for *the honor of Grayskull*, whatever that means.”

Catra stood still, not saying a word.

“Catra, please,” Adora pleaded. “Trust me. We can figure this out together.” She reached out her hand. “Please come back to me.”

Catra crossed her arms and took a single step back toward Adora. “Are you sure?” she asked. Her voice was weak, she still sounded scared of Adora.

“I am,” Adora said. “I’m always going to be here for you.”

Catra slowly crept to Adora, her arms still crossed. It seemed like she was cold, but Adora felt warm. Catra reached out and delicately grabbed Adora's hand.

"C'mere." Adora gently pulled Catra to her. Catra laid on Adora's chest with her arms pulled close and Adora wrapped her arms around her. "I'm sorry I scared you."

Catra whimpered into Adora. Adora winced; her breasts were still very sensitive, but it was okay, she just wanted to comfort Catra. She felt something wet drip onto her shirt, as she looked down, she realized that Catra was crying.

"Hey, hey, it's okay," Adora said softly. She pet Catra's mane softly. "I'm here, I'm here, Catra."

"I was so scared," Catra sobbed. "I thought you were a *princess*, I thought you were going to turn on me."

"Hey, hey," Adora said. She lifted Catra's chin so she could look into her eyes. "Nothing could ever make me leave you, Catra. I will never be your enemy. You're safe with me."

"You promise?" Catra asked.

"I promise."

Catra suddenly reached up and hugged Adora over her shoulders. "I love you," she whimpered softly into Adora's neck.

They both froze. Adora was surprised, not only that Catra had said it, but also that she clearly hadn't meant to say it out loud. Catra's feelings toward Adora had always been unclear to her. Obviously, Catra liked her the most of anyone in the Horde, but it didn't seem like she liked anyone else. Adora had never gotten the impression that those feelings were romantic, though it's not like they'd been taught exactly what romance was. It wasn't really the Horde's highest priority.

Adora's feelings toward Catra had also always been unclear. She did like other people like the other members of their squad, Lonnie, Kyle, and Rogelio. But Catra was always different, special. She was more important to her than anyone else, maybe more than anyone else could be.

"Shit." Catra let go of Adora and sat up. "Adora, I'm sorry, I didn't mean-"

"Catra, wait." Adora caught her hands to stop her from getting up. "I love you too."

Catra's eyes went wide, and she stopped trying to push away Adora. "Do you really mean that?" she asked breathlessly.

"Of course I do," Adora said. She stared into Catra's eyes with determination.

"You promise?" Catra repeated.
"I prom-"

Catra cut Adora off by grabbing her face and kissing her. Adora closed her eyes and leaned in as they fell to the ground. She pulled Catra close as she sank deeper into their kiss. This was a moment she never wanted to end.

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

I like the idea of Adora staying with the Horde and I've never felt like I've seen it done justice, so here I am doing it myself! This is probably going to be three works long, excluding the one-shot I wrote already, all of about equal-length. I have had so much fun writing this and I hope you all have as much fun reading it.

Comments are always appreciated!

She-Ra

Chapter Summary

Adora explores her new powers and her new relationship with Catra. The rebellion braces for an imminent new threat.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“You positive we’re going the right way, Glimmer?” Bow asked.

Glimmer teleported right in front of him. “I know what I'm doing, Bow” she said. “Can you please just trust me for once?” She teleported away again into another tree.

“You know I always trust you,” Bow said. “But I'm starting to get a little freaked out.” He leaped over a particularly large log. “I mean, I pretty much grew up in these woods and I've never even seen this part of them. I've heard stories about weird stuff out here.”

“It's fine, okay?” Glimmer said. “Just let me figure this out.”

“Okay,” Bow said. “So, are we going to talk about it?”

“Talk about what?” Glimmer asked.

“You know,” Bow said. “The whole ‘legendary magical warrior fated to come to us in our hour of greatest need appears but is fighting for the Horde’ thing.”

“What is there to talk about?” Glimmer said “We’re going to tell my mom and she’s going to figure something out. It’s going to be fine.”

“Uh, I don’t know about that,” Bow said. “The rebellion has already been struggling, I don’t think you’re mom can just

magically come up with a solution now that the problem is much worse."

"We'll just bring her to our side," Glimmer said, she was clearly getting more frustrated. "Then the Horde won't have her and we will. Simple!"

"Do you really think we can just *convince* a Horde soldier to stop being a Horde soldier?" Bow asked. "Has that ever happened before?"

"I don't know!" Glimmer shouted.

"Okay, sorry," Bow said. "Let's just focus on getting back to Brightmoon."

Catra and Adora lay there on the ground of the Whispering Woods for a while. Adora wasn't letting her get up, and it's not like Catra wanted to anyway. This was what she had always wanted, Adora loved her. Not only that, she was kissing her a lot too.

Adora pulled away. "You know, we do have to go back at some point," she said. "The invasion of Thaymor is soon." She loosened her grip on Catra's back.

"Why did you have to ruin this, Adora?" Catra said. "Can't you just enjoy things?"

"Sorry, sorry," Adora said. "I just don't want to get in more trouble than we're already in."
"Oh shit! Shadow Weaver is going to be so fucking mad." Catra stood up and began pacing around the clearing, clutching her head. "What are we going to do, Adora?"

“Hey, hey!” Adora tried to calm Catra down. She stood up and lowered Catra’s arms down from her head. “Look at me.” Catra lifted her head to look Adora in the eyes. “We’re going to be okay. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other.”

Catra recognized the obvious allusion to their childhood conversations. She followed along with, “You promise?”
“I promise.”

“Glimmer! Where have you been?” Queen Angella shouted. She stood at the entrance to Castle Brightmoon, flanked by two royal guards.

“Hey, Mom,” Glimmer said, clearly annoyed with having to see her.

“All of Brightmoon was worried sick,” Angella said. “What were you thinking?”

“Mom!”

“How could you be so selfish and disobedient?” she asked.

“Your majesty, we were searching for First Ones’ tech,” Bow explained. “I picked up the most powerful signal on my tracker pad that I’ve ever seen.”

“That would be a poor excuse to run away with my daughter, even if you had brought it back,” Angella said. “And seeing as you didn’t-”

“Mom!” Glimmer shouted. “The entire rebellion is in grave danger!”

The entire chamber went silent. Glimmer could feel the gazes of everyone on the three of them.

“What do you mean, Glimmer?” Angella asked harshly. “What did you find in the woods?”

“We found a sword made of First Ones’ tech,” Glimmer said. “But before we could get it, a Horde soldier grabbed it and transformed into She-Ra!”

Gasp!

“She-Ra?” Angella said. “Are you sure?”
“Yes!” Glimmer said, exasperated. “We tried to stop her but she fought us and we barely got out of there!”

Angella hugged Glimmer. “I’m just glad your safe.”

“Thank you, Mom.” Glimmer hugged back.

“We’ll talk about this later,” Angella said, releasing the hug. “Now, go to your room!”

“Ugh,” Glimmer groaned, but followed her mother’s orders and teleported to her room.

“Bow,” Angella started.

Bow kneeled. “I’m sorry, your majesty, I shouldn’t have dragged Glimmer out.”

“Thank you for keeping her safe,” Angella said. “Dark times are coming for Etheria, you two are going to need each other now more than ever.”

“Thank you, your majesty.” Bow stood back up.

“Tomorrow, I’m going to need you and Glimmer to set out and bring the other princesses to Brightmoon for a meeting,” Angella said. “We need to discuss with them what to do about this new threat we’re facing. I can only hope that we will be ready.”

The skiff ride back to the Fright Zone was painfully short. Catra wished she could've had more time alone with Adora before they were interrupted by…

"Shadow Weaver!" Adora shouted as she pulled up on the control stick, grinding the skiff to a halt.

Shadow Weaver stood before the entrance to the Fright Zone. She was alone, but her magic aura emanating was so strong it made Catra's fur stand on end. "Where have you *been?"* She shadowy aura grew larger with her anger.

"Oh, so you finally care about me, huh?" Catra snapped, stepping down from the skiff.

"You insolent *rat!*" Shadow Weaver hissed. She raised her hand and shadowy tendrils began to creep their way up Catra's legs. "You *dare* speak to your commanding officer that way? I never though you would be so bold as to try to drag Adora out of the Fright Zone, you *turncoat.*"

"Leave her alone!" Adora shouted, stepping between them. "It was my idea to leave, and we always intended to come back. We were out to find this," she pulled the sword off her back and held it in two hands. "Perhaps you can explain it."

"Where did you get that?" Shadow Weaver asked in astonishment. The tendrils released Catra and slithered back under Shadow Weaver's cloak.

"We found it in the woods," Adora said. "I used it and it transformed me into-"

"*She-Ra,*" Shadow Weaver finished. "I always sensed great power in you, Adora, but I never thought the legends could be true, much less be about *you.*"

"So you *do* know what's going on," Catra said. "Care to elaborate?"

"I will do so for *Adora's* sake," Shadow Weaver spat. "Not yours, Catra."

Why does she always need to be so cruel to me? Catra thought, crossing her arms and leaning against the skiff.

"The legend goes," Shadow Weaver started, "that She-Ra, the mighty princess of power, strongest-"

"Ha! Princess!" Catra snorted. "Isn't that ironic."

Shadow Weaver threw a dangerous glance at Catra but continued. "Strongest of all the princesses, will come to Etheria in its greatest hour of need and rid it of all evil."

"All evil?" Catra asked. "Wouldn't that mean that she would have to get rid of herself too, seeing as she's a princess?"

"Catra, if you continue to interrupt me I will throw you in the deepest cell in the detainment block to rot!" Shadow Weaver yelled.

"Enough threats," Adora said. "What are you saying, Shadow Weaver?"

"I'm saying that you are the key to the Horde's victory, Adora," Shadow Weaver said. "With your power, we can finally crush the Brightmoon rebellion once and for all! You will be the hero of the Horde! Come, we must begin your training at once! The invasion of Thaymor is tomorrow and you need to be ready."

"Training?" Adora said. "I thought I just had to wave the sword around and say the thing and poof! She-Ra." She waved the sword around to demonstrate.

"The power of She-Ra can only be wielded properly by one with the strength to command it," Shadow Weaver said. "You must

prepare your mind and body properly, or you will be unable to use it. You must be ready for tomorrow!"

"Do you really think you can get this doofus ready in twenty-four hours?" Catra said.

"Without *you* distracting her, I'm sure she'll turn out just fine," Shadow Weaver droned. "Return to the barracks, Cadet. I have much to discuss with the *Force Captain.*"

"It'll be fine, Catra," Adora said. "I'll see you later, I promise."

Catra smirked at Adora before walking off to the barracks. She knew that Shadow Weaver was up to something, she just couldn't figure out what it was. Could she be trying to steal the power of She-Ra, or whatever it really was, from Adora?

"Hey, Catra." Adora entered the locker room.

"Hey, Adora," Catra said, not looking up. "Shouldn't you be off training with Shadow Weaver?"

"No," Adora said. "Her *encouragement,*" she flicked her fingers to imitate quotation marks, "hasn't been very helpful. I haven't been able to turn into She-Ra at all." She sat down on the bench next to Catra. "What have you been up to?"

"Absolutely nothing." Catra laid down on Adora's lap. "It's so boring here without you."

"Yeah, I'm sorry," Adora chuckled. "It turns out that I get my own room now that I'm a Force Captain, wanna see?"

"Are you serious?" Catra sat up abruptly. "I gotta see this!"

Adora led Catra through the twisting hallways of the Horde barracks to a small room far away from the cadet rooms they had grown up in. It had a bed that was raised off the ground, a desk, and even a private bathroom.

"Wow, this place is amazing!" Catra said. "You get this all to yourself?"
"Yeah, it's pretty incredible," Adora said.

"Wait, how am I going to be able to see you if you live so far away?" Catra asked nervously.

"Um, well," Adora said. "I didn't ask, and definitely don't tell Shadow Weaver that I said this, but I was thinking you could live here. You know, with me?"

"Oh." Catra's tail curled, wrapping around her leg. She looked down to try to obscure her obvious blushing. "Are you sure that's a good idea?"
"Aren't you supposed to be the reckless one?" Adora asked, walking over to Catra. She lifted her chin up to look her in the eyes. "Where's your sense of adventure, Catra?" She leaned down and kissed her.

The door suddenly opened and the two broke away hastily. Shadow Weaver floated into the room. "Adjusting well to your new room, I see," she said.

"Um," Adora coughed. "Yes, sir." She stood at attention.

"I see you brought a guest, *how lovely.*"

"What, am I not allowed to be here?" Catra asked.

"On the contrary," Shadow Weaver said. "I'd prefer it if you were. Adora was the only member of your squad who could keep you in line and I'd prefer if that influence continued. I already know about your little sleeping arrangements. Don't think me a *fool.*"
"Yes, Shadow Weaver," Adora said. "I'll keep an eye on her."

“Good,” Shadow Weaver said. “I will see you tomorrow morning at first moonrise for training. We *will* be ready for Thaymor.” She glared at Catra. “No *distractions.*” She floated out of the room and the door shut behind her.

“That was fucking ominous,” Catra said.

“Yeah, she seemed really mad at during training.” Adora looked worried. “I think she was making it harder though. She kept yelling at me.”

“She definitely knows more than she’s letting on,” Catra said. “There’s something more to this sword and she knows what it is.”

“You’re probably right,” Adora said. “Don’t worry about her, though, she has no power in this room. What kind of girlfriend would I be if I ratted you out to her?”
“Oh, um.” Catra blushed and turned away.

“Oh shit,” Adora said. “I’m sorry, I thought you meant-”

“No, I like it, Adora,” Catra said. “It’s just you hadn’t said it before now and it sounded strange coming out of your mouth.”

“Speaking of my mouth,” Adora said suggestively. “We did kind of just get rudely interrupted.”

“Yeah, we were in the middle of something, weren’t we?” Catra asked, walking back over to Adora.

Adora cupped Catra’s cheeks in two hands and began to kiss her again. Catra leaned into her as she did, her tail wrapping around one of Adora’s legs.

“That’s new,” Adora said. “You’re never done this before.”

“You’ve also never given me mouth-to-mouth that wasn’t medically necessary,” Catra said. “We seem to be doing a lot of new things together.”

“Hm, good,” Adora said. She leaned back into Catra and continued kissing her. They had each other now, and not even Shadow Weaver could take that away.

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

Sorry for something a little boring after waiting, but we are on the edge of greatness! More exciting things are coming soon and I cannot wait for you guys to experience them.

Also, Happy Birthday Catra!

Comments are always appreciated!

The Invasion of Thaymor Part 1

Chapter Summary

Adora makes preparations for war. Catra sneaks onto a tank.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora woke up early. Catra was sleeping at the foot of her bed like she always did. Adora was disappointed that she hadn't slept next to her, but she had been too nervous to ask her last night. She carefully got out of bed, still finding it weird to not be sleeping level with the ground. It was nice though, she felt like royalty, like a *princess*. That word meant something different to her now. She had always been taught that the princesses were evil, but now she *was* a princess; supposedly the strongest of them all, destined for greatness.

Catra stirred. "Adora?"
"Hey," Adora whispered. "It's super early, go back to sleep."

"Come on," Catra purred. "Can't I see my girlfriend before she goes galavanting off to save the world?"

"I suppose so." Adora leaned down and gently placed a kiss on Catra's forehead. "I love you."
"I love you too," Catra said. "I still don't see why I can't come with you."

"Shadow Weaver says you're not ready for active duty yet," Adora said. "And besides-"

"I'm ready." Catra sat up. "I'm more ready than anyone else, why can't she see that?"
"I don't disagree with you," Adora said. "I'm just not sure I can change her mind about that."

“Ugh.” Catra laid back down. “Whatever, I don’t even care about it anyway.”

“Sure,” Adora said. “Besides, I’d prefer if you didn’t come. I’m still getting used to She-Ra, and I’m not sure I’ll be able to protect you.”

“I don’t need you to protect me, Adora,” Catra said. “I’m not fucking helpless.”

“*I* need to protect you,” Adora said. “I don’t know what I’d do if my *girlfriend* got seriously hurt in battle. You’re really important to me, Catra.”

“Fine,” Catra said. “I’ll be here, patiently awaiting your heroic return.”

“Sure you will,” Adora said. “You’ll probably be making it known just how much you deserve to be in the field. I promise it will be soon.”

“Thank you, Adora.”

“You’re welcome, Catra,” Adora said. “I love you.”
“I love you too.”

Adora waited for Catra to go back to sleep before continuing to prepare for the day. She could tell when she was asleep by the low, content purr she made. Adora thought it was very cute. She went over to her locker and changed into her uniform, proudly putting on her shiny Force Captain’s pin after looking at it in the mirror for probably too long.

“You’re late.” Shadow Weaver stood with her back to the door of the private training room. “Our troops move out in only five hours,

we are going to have to use that entire time."

"Sorry, Shadow Weaver," Adora yawned. "I'm not used to getting up this early. I barely got any sleep."

"Whatever *shenanigans* you and Catra got up to last night is not my problem, Force Captain," Shadow Weaver said. She turned to face Adora and began to float toward her. "You are supposed to keep her in line, not stoop to her level. Do I make myself clear?"

"Yes, Shadow Weaver," Adora said.

"Excellent." Shadow Weaver stopped. She placed her hands together with her fingers facing the floor. "Let us begin, then."

The silence in Adora's room when it was empty was deafening to Catra. She had pretended to fall back asleep to make sure that Adora left. She was very convincing when she wanted to be.

It wasn't fair. Adora had always gotten all the attention, even before she was She-Ra. Catra had always been just as good as her, sometimes even better. She deserved to be given a chance like Thaymor where she could really prove her worth in the Horde to Shadow Weaver, or maybe even to Lord Hordak himself.

Maybe I could get that chance, Catra thought.

Catra walked out of Adora's room and down the hallways to the giant garage, where preparations for the upcoming battle were taking place. Tanks were being fueled up and loaded with equipment, crates and boxes filled with new weapons and armor were being moved in, and the remaining Force Captains were discussing something or other. She spotted a tank that had been fully loaded and, crucially, was devoid of people. Creeping in, Catra saw that of the crates had been opened and some of the

equipment had been taken out. She folded herself into it and pulled the lid down on top of her.

I'll show them, I'll show them all how wrong they were about me.

"You must concentrate on your goal, Adora," Shadow Weaver said. "The power of She-Ra must have direction, it must have a focal point."
"I'm trying!" Adora grunted. Nothing they had tried in the past four hours had worked. Shadow Weaver's advice was as vague and unhelpful as ever, and Adora was no closer to understanding the power of She-Ra. "For the honor of Grayskull!" She felt a rush of… something for a moment, but the feeling went as quickly as it came.

"No, no, no, Adora, you're not listening to me," Shadow Weaver said. "You cannot transform into She-Ra on a whim. There must be purpose and clarity in your actions. Do you understand me?"

"No, I don't!" Adora yelled. She lowered the sword. "Nothing you've said in the last two days has made any sense whatsoever. I could transform just fine without your help in the woods, and now I can't get anything to work at all. The only thing that's different now is you!" Adora recoiled, in horror at what she had just said.

"Are you insinuating that *I* am somehow trying to sabotage you, Force Captain?" Shadow Weaver shouted. "I have done nothing but try to make sure that you succeed at every turn, I have only ever wanted what's best for you, and now you turn around and *blame* me for your failures?"

"Shit, Shadow Weaver, I'm sorry," Adora stammered. "I didn't mean-"
"No, Adora." Shadow Weaver lifted her hand to silence her. "I

understand perfectly well."
"You do?" Adora asked, confused.

"Yes," Shadow Weaver said. "Catra has distracted you, confused you. She has tried to convince you of her warped perception of my intentions. It has been very clear to me that she distrusted me when I first mentioned She-Ra to you yesterday, and it hurt me dearly. What has hurt me even more is that you seem to believe her lies as well."

"Shadow Weaver, I'm sorry-" Adora started.

"Now, now, child," Shadow Weaver interrupted. She placed a hand on Adora's cheek. "I understand perfectly well why she would do that, she's never been as trusting of me as you are. I only what what's best for the both of you. I implore you, don't let Catra turn you against me. I'm the *only* one who can teach you how to control the power of She-Ra."

"I understand, Shadow Weaver," Adora said. "I know what I have to do." *That was a bunch of bullshit,* she thought. *Catra was right, she's clearly up to something. After we defeat the rebels at Thaymor, we'll find out what it is.* "I think I'm ready."

"Really?" Shadow Weaver asked, surprised. "I must say, you've always been full of great potential."

Adora nodded. She held the sword high above her head and shouted. "*For the honor of Grayskull!*"

The familiar sensation she had felt back in the Whispering Woods returned. She felt the magic of the sword flow through her, changing her into She-Ra. Shadow Weaver looked up at her in this new form with a clear expression of envy, even from behind the mask.

"I knew you could do it, Adora," Shadow Weaver said. "Now, you must lead our forces to victory at Thaymor!"

“I will do what I must.” Adora reverted back to normal and placed the sword on her back. “The fortress of Thaymor will fall to the Horde today.”

“Excellent.”

Adora walked out of the room with Shadow Weaver trailing behind her.

“Force Captain Octavia will brief you on the plan of attack,” Shadow Weaver explained. “Her team will come from the North, yours will come from the South. You two will meet up in the middle and cut East. Hopefully, your mission will be finished in a few hours, barring any interference from any *princesses.*”

“There aren’t any princesses stationed in Thaymor?” Adora asked.

“Not to our knowledge,” Shadow Weaver said. “That is the reason it was selected for this attack. It is a crucial location for control of the Whispering Woods with insufficient defenses.”

“I understand,” Adora said. “What happens if a princess does show up?”

“The power of She-Ra should be more than a match for any of them,” Shadow Weaver said. “The closest would be Glimmer of Brightmoon, but she is much weaker than the others. Her powers are shared with her mother, the Queen.”

“That’s a little embarrassing,” Adora chuckled. “For both of them. I’m pretty sure she was the one I saw in the woods. She and an archer were also after the sword.”

“What?” Shadow Weaver stopped. “You faced a princess alone?”

“Well, not alone,” Adora said. “Catra was with me. She seemed to fight the princess off pretty well.”
“Your assessment of the Cadet’s abilities was not required, Force Captain,” Shadow Weaver snapped. “That is my job. Please explain how *you* fought off the princess.”

“She and the other rebel just ran off as soon as I transformed into She-Ra,” Adora said. “I think they were going to report it to the Queen.”

“Interesting,” Shadow Weaver said. “It seems the rebellion is preparing for you, Adora. They should be on high alert, and I would expect the arrival of at least Princess Glimmer. From what we’ve gathered, she seems reckless enough to charge into this battle even though she knows she cannot win.”

“Well then, this should be easy.” Adora turned the corner and stepped through the doorway to the massive garage. Force Captain Octavia stood at the other end, consulting with some soldiers. “I’ll see you after the battle.” She waved goodbye to Shadow Weaver.

“Yes,” Shadow Weaver said. “I look forward to the news of your victory.” She floated back around the corner to who knows where.

Adora jogged across the garage to Octavia. “Ah, Force Captain Adora,” she said. “That’s a nice sword you’ve got there.”
“Thanks,” Adora panted. “This place is huge.”

“Yeah, it’s got a nice echo too,” Octavia said. She turned to the soldiers standing around her. “You’re dismissed. Get to your stations and don’t get left behind.”

“Yes, Force Captain,” they said in unison, saluting Octavia. They ran off in different directions.

“Shadow Weaver told me that you were going to brief me on the attack plan,” Adora said.

“Yeah,” Octavia said. “Did she say anything else about it?”

“She said that I’m coming up from the South, then we’re heading East together,” Adora said.
“Huh,” Octavia said, looking down at her comm pad. “Well, don’t tell any of our superiors I said this, but that’s pretty much it. They

may talk a lot about advanced battle strategies, but when you're in the field, the chaos throws pretty much everything else out."

"Oh," Adora said. "Well, okay then. I guess if that's it…"

"My only real strategy advice is to not get stuck in a place where you can be easily ambushed," Octavia said. "If there are any princesses crawling about, they could be quite nasty."

"Understood," Adora said.
"Great," Octavia said. "Your forces are waiting for you on the other side of the garage. You'll be riding in on the front tank."

"Of course they are," Adora said, exasperated. "I guess I'll see you at the center of Thaymor?"

"If all goes according to plan, then yes." Octavia typed a few more things on her comm pad. "We're moving out immediately, so go get ready."

"Great."

Adora went to the other side of the massive garage, choosing to walk this time.

"Force Captain Adora," one of her sergeants greeted her. "We're all ready to move out, just waiting for the order, sir."

Adora winced at the last word. She knew that it was standard Horde protocol and that they probably didn't know any better, but it was still unpleasant. She really couldn't afford to get dysphoric at a time like this. "Very good, sergeant." She stepped into the tank at the front of the line and grabbed one of the handles dangling from the ceiling. "We are moving out immediately. Tell the troops to get in their vehicles or get left behind. We're diverting from Force Captain Octavia's forces at the tree line. She's covering the North and we're covering the South."

"Yes, Force Captain," the sergeant said. She ran off to her vehicle while passing down the orders to the other soldiers through the

comm in her helmet.

You can do this, Adora thought to herself. *You're She-Ra, nothing you can face out there can stop you.* The door of the tank closed and the engine roared to live as it began to hover forward. *There's no turning back now.*

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

Exciting things are happening next time! Shadow Weaver's machinations are all leading to this moment, will it pay off for her? Regardless, more catradora angst will surely ensue.

On a serious note, the American election is on Tuesday, and I, an American, am extremely nervous. This part of the story is already all written, so don't worry about that, but I might not be able to continue writing if the state of the world gets too hectic. So, hopefully that doesn't happen because, among other, more important things, I have been having an absolute blast writing this fic.

Comments are always appreciated!

The Invasion of Thaymor Part 2

Chapter Summary

Catra maybe kills someone. Adora gets real mad.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The ride to Thaymor was surprisingly bumpy for a vehicle that didn't touch the ground.

Who the hell designed this thing? Catra asked herself, although she wasn't really in a position to complain about the conditions of her trip. After all, she was a stowaway.

Mercifully, the tank eventually came to a halt. Catra heard the door open and the troops standing inside clear out onto the battlefield. After a few minutes, she could hear the sounds of the battle around her, but nothing inside the tank itself.

Slowly, Catra lifted the lid of the crate and took a much-needed breath of fresh air. She was alone in the tank. *Perfect.* She grabbed a stun baton and a knife and walked out onto the battlefield.

It was pure chaos. It couldn't have been more than two minutes and the town was already littered with fire, rubble, and the corpses of both rebels and horde soldiers.

How do you manage to die that quickly? Catra thought.

"Catra? You weren't assigned to this mission. What the hell are you doing here?"

"Oh, Octavia!" Catra shouted. "Great to see you. I love the new eyepatch by the way, did Shadow Weaver pick it out for you?

"Reckless and insubordinate as always, I see," Octavia grunted. "Get somewhere safe before you get killed!" She tased a fleeing rebel with her stun baton.

"And you're still a dumb-face," Catra laughed. "Don't worry, *Force Captain,* I'll survive just fine!" She scampered off through the chaos, searching with her nose for Adora.

"Catra!" Octavia shouted, before being forced to engage in physical combat with a tall goat person with a stick. She punched the man in the face, knocking him to the ground with blood dripping from his nose. "Get back here!" She turned to chase Catra but couldn't find her in the smoke.

Ha! What an idiot! Catra thought. *We'll see who's the one who needs to get somewhere safe.* She continued off through the battlefield.

The tank Adora was in kept jostling her about. She felt like this was not normal, considering that the vehicle didn't even touch the ground. The other soldiers didn't seem to mind though, so she kept it to herself. They had all ben silent the entire ride; none of them had even greeted her as she stepped in the tank.

Adora was extremely nervous, and the silence didn't help. She couldn't stop thinking about what could go wrong. *What if I choke and can't command my soldiers?* she thought. *What if I choke and can't transform into She-Ra? What if I choke and get someone killed? What if* I *get killed?* Adora took a deep breath to calm herself. *Relax, Shadow Weaver said this should be easy. Even if a princess shows up, I can stop them.*

The tank slowed to a halt. Adora could hear the sounds of battle outside already: shouting, explosions, and Horde bots. The door of the tank creaked open. The bright light of Etheria's many

moons flooded the dimly lit tank. Adora squinted and raised a hand to cover her eyes.

She pulled her sword off her pack and pointed it forward. "Move out!"

"Yes, Force Captain!" the soldiers shouted. They grabbed their weapons and ran out of the tank.

Adora walked out of the tank and the smell of fire and blood greeted her. The other tanks arrived next to her and deposited their soldiers to the battle. It was loud, hot, and overwhelming.

Adora walked in front of the line of tanks. Before her was what could only be described as absolute chaos. Horde soldiers were fighting with ragged and ill-equipped rebel soldiers. Bodies were already littered across the battlefield and buildings were already in flames.

So this is why we're here, Adora thought. *The rebels will leave this world in chaos, but we will bring order.* She walked forward and raised her sword above her head. "*For the honor of Grayskull!*"

"Glimmer?" Angella knocked on her daughter's door.

"Ugh, what?" Glimmer said, muffled by the thick metal.

"I just wanted to check in on you, Glimmer," Angella said. "May I come in?"

"Fine," Glimmer groaned. Angella heard her teleport to the door and it swung open slightly.

"Thank you." Angella stepped into the room. "I wanted to talk to you about the situation with the rebellion."

“You do?” Glimmer asked. “I thought I was grounded.”

“Well, consider yourself un-grounded,” Angella said. “I need you to fight for the rebellion, now more than ever.”

“Really?” Glimmer said.
“Yes,” Angella said. “As you said, the rebellion is in grave danger, and I will need you to-”

“Your majesty, the Horde has attacked Thaymor!” A guard came running into Glimmer’s room.

“What?” Angella said. “When did this happen?”

“Right now,” the guard said. “The citizens are being evacuated as we speak. They’re saying that a princess has joined the Horde, although they can’t say which.”

“She-Ra,” Glimmer said with gritted teeth. “We have to stop her.”

“I do not like your odds in this fight, Glimmer,” Angella said. “You will need the aid of the other princesses if you are to defeat her. But we do not have the time to get them. Go to Thaymor, but focus on aiding the evacuation. I don’t want you to get hurt.”

“Yes, Mom,” Glimmer groaned. “But if she attacks me directly, can I-”

“Yes, you may fight She-Ra in order to defend yourself,” Angella said. “Now go! The people of Thaymor need you.”

Glimmer saluted her mother before disappearing in a puff of pink sparkles.

“Are you sure that was the right choice, your majesty?” the guard asked.

“No,” Angella said. “But I’m afraid we have no other options.”

"Bow!" Glimmer teleported right next to the archer. He was currently tinkering with one of his arrows. "Let's go!"

"Ah!" Bow fell out of his chair. "Why? What's going on?"

"Thaymor is being invaded!" Glimmer said excitedly. "And my mom has sent me to assist with the evacuation!"

"Maybe try not to sound so happy about it?" Bow said.

"Why would I not be happy about my mom sending me on a mission?" Glimmer asked.

"Whatever," Bow said. "Let's go." He grabbed his finished arrows and reached for Glimmer's hand.

"Yes!" Glimmer grabbed Bow's hand and teleported away.

Adora walked North through the streets of Thaymor. Most of her soldiers were ahead of her, so all she saw was what remained of the rebel outpost. More bodies were scattered throughout the battlefield, and a shocking number of them were children. Adora winced. She had heard of cadets not surviving the training, but she had never actually seen a dead child, in-person or just a picture.

Adora picked up her pace. *Either the rebels are using child soldiers or are letting them wander around the military forts,* she thought. *Either way, they need to be stopped.* She was probably far behind her forces now. Even as she started to jog, more of the stragglers were passing her. *Shit, I need to get further ahead.* Luckily, she was now She-Ra, and therefore had exceptionally long

legs with which to run with. She sprinted forward, making a beeline for the meeting spot with Force Captain Octavia. She passed several of her soldiers that were engaged in brawls with rebels, all of which seemed to be going in her soldiers' favors. She smiled to herself. *This is going great!*

"Hey, Adora."

Adora dug her heel into the ground and ground to a halt. "Catra? What are you doing here?" She looked around frantically, but couldn't see her anywhere.

"Up here, silly," Catra laughed.

Adora looked up and saw Catra perched on top of one of the roofs.

"I told you to stay home, Catra," Adora said. "How did you get here?"

"I hid in a tank," Catra said, shrugging. "I guess people didn't check what was inside the crates they were loading. It's honestly really incompetent. I mean, what *egregiously* low standards do we have for our soldiers?"

"Oh, I get it!" Adora shouted. "You wanted your chance and you didn't get it. You didn't listen to Shadow Weaver, and you didn't even listen to *me.* I thought we agreed that you weren't coming."
"And I thought we agreed to look out for each other," Catra said. "But apparently you trust Shadow Weaver more than me!"
"I never said that!" Adora said. "I only wanted to keep you safe!"

Catra screamed and lunged at Adora. Adora was stunned for a fraction of a second, before raising her sword to block the incoming attack from her girlfriend.

But Catra didn't land on Adora. She had instead landed right past her shoulder on a rebel that had snuck up on her while they were yelling. The impact of Catra's landing had knocked them to the

ground, and she scratched up their face until they stopped moving.

"Who's the one who needs to be kept safe?" Catra asked coldly. She stood up, her claws covered in blood.

"Fine," Adora said. "I have to meet Force Captain Octavia in the center of town soon, so try to keep up.

"Keep up? Ha!" Catra laughed. "I came from her side of the battle. You're the one who needs to keep up with me!" She leapt up the side of the nearest building and scampered North along the rooftops.

Adora tried to stay mad, but she couldn't. Catra was one of the best fighters in the Horde and she knew it. She looked down at her would-be attacker and sighed. The damage Catra had done was severe, and Adora couldn't tell if they were still breathing. This was war, and it was now more real for them that it had ever been. Adora had deluded herself into believing that she could protect Catra from it, but really she was just trying to protect herself. She ran off after Catra, into the smoke and fire of battle.

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Glimmer teleported her and Bow to the Eastern end of town. Even from there, she could see smoke billowing in the wind. A line of refugees was running past them; families, children, the elderly, all of them victims of the Horde's brutal attack.

"How could they do this?" Glimmer said, tears beginning to form in her eyes. "How could they attack a peaceful village like Thaymor?"

"We know why," Bow said grimly. "All we can do now is help these people."

"Right." Glimmer wiped the tears from her eyes. "You help these people escape to Brightmoon, I'll go find She-Ra."

“Glimmer, wait!” Bow said, grabbing her arm. “Your mom said to assist with the evacuation, and there’s no way you’re strong enough to fight She-Ra on your own.”

“I have to try!” Glimmer shouted. “She just appeared a few days ago, so maybe she hasn’t fully developed her powers yet. This is the one chance we get to fight when she’s weaker, and I have to take it.”

“Okay,” Bow said. “But please come back *immediately* if you get into trouble.”
“I will,” Glimmer promised.

Bow let go of Glimmer’s arm and she teleported away. She reappeared in the center of town, with Horde soldiers surrounding her.

“Who wants a piece of me?” Glimmer shouted. She blasted a group of three of them and they all fell backwards into a nearby building. “Where’s your She-Ra?”

“Not here.”

Glimmer turned to see a tall green octopus woman holding a stun baton and wearing a Horde insignia as an eyepatch.

“But I’d be happy to show you the power of Force Captain Octavia!” the woman shouted. She charged at Glimmer, baton poised to strike.

Glimmer teleported behind her and blasted her with magic. “Who?” she laughed.

Octavia fell forward on her face, grunting. She pushed herself up to her knees and looked back and Glimmer. “Typical princess,” she said. “Always using dirty tricks.”
“Typical Horde scum,” Glimmer said. “Always attacking innocent people.”

Octavia began another charge, but Glimmer blasted her again. She flew backwards and hit a building, making a small crater in its wall. She fell to the ground, unconscious.

"Anyone else?" Glimmer shouted. The other soldiers began to back away. "Huh, seems like you're all a bunch of cowards."

"Not all of us."
Glimmer turned around again and saw the one thing she had came here for: She-Ra. She was taller than Glimmer remembered, towering over the other Horde soldiers.

"Glimmer of Brightmoon," She-Ra said. "You should leave now. The rebellion has lost this battle."

"Oh, shit," Glimmer said to herself under her breath.

Adora quickly realized how ill-equipped she was to fight a princess. The training she had gone through had never felt particularly convincing when it came to the difficulty of the opponents, but the princess of Brightmoon was many orders of magnitude stronger than a Horde bot. For one, she could fucking teleport out away from her strikes whenever she felt like it, and had a seemingly unlimited supply of magical blasts she could throw at Adora from any direction she felt like. She was struggling, but her years of training had not totally failed her. She had always been top of her squad at hand-to hand combat, and predicting her opponent's next move was a crucial part of that.

Adora swung her sword in an arc behind her, grazing Glimmer's cape as she reappeared behind her. Adora wound up for another strike, but the princess disappeared in another annoying puff of pink glitter as she followed through.

“So this is the mighty She-Ra?” Glimmer taunted. “Or are you a flimsy imitation created by the Horde?”

“I am the real She-Ra!” Adora yelled. “Not that a half-princess like you would know!”

Glimmer froze for a split second and Adora took her chance, landing a solid punch before she could teleport away again.

“What would a Horde soldier know of being a princess?” Glimmer said.

“Enough to know that I will be a better one than any of you!” Adora shouted. She swung her sword again, but Glimmer teleported away, this time right in front of Adora’s face.

“You will *never* be like us,” Glimmer said. She punched Adora in the face, her hand powered up by magical energy.

Adora fell to the ground, her vision blurred and ears ringing. She could feel her She-Ra form starting to fade, and it took all her concentration to keep it up.

“Not so strong, are you?” Glimmer taunted. She stalked toward Adora, fists glowing with magical energy. “This is the mighty She-Ra that’s supposed to bring the Horde victory?”

Adora groaned.

“Apparently not,” Glimmer said. “After all, you’re just another Horde sold-” She was interrupted by Catra leaping at her and decking her.

“Don’t touch her!” Catra shouted. “Hey, sparkles, remember me?”

Glimmer blasted Catra off of her. “Looks like She-Ra has a bodyguard,” she said. “I thought she was supposed to be powerful.”

Catra leapt forward and swiped at Glimmer with her claws. Glimmer teleported behind her but Adora came in and rammed her with her shoulder.

“I am powerful,” Adora said. “I just don’t fight dirty, like you!”

“Argh!” Glimmer yelled. “Leave Thaymor alone!” She sent another blast at Adora, who dodged it and charged in. Glimmer took a few steps back, but Catra turned and swept her feet out from under her with a swift low kick.

Adora walked over to Glimmer and pointed her sword at her. “This battle is over,” she said. “Leave. Now.”

“The Horde will never win,” Glimmer said, before teleporting away.

“Bow!” Glimmer teleported back to the edge of town.

“Glimmer! What happened?” Bow said. “What’s going on?”

“You were right,” Glimmer said. “She’s too strong. I thought I had her, but she’s just too much!”

“I hate to say that I told you so,” Bow said.

“Let’s just focus on the evacuation!” Glimmer shouted. “More Horde soldiers are coming and she’s sure to be with them.”
“I told you so,” Bow teased.

“Whatever!”

Adora let out a sigh of relief and finally dropped her She-Ra form. “That was more difficult that I expected,” she panted.

“Not too shabby, *princess,*” Catra laughed. “Although you do need to do more training.”

“Yeah, probably,” Adora chuckled. She walked over to where Octavia was laying and reached out her hand. “Are you okay, Force Captain?”

“Thanks,” Octavia said, grabbing Adora’s hand and pulling herself up. “I didn’t expect another princess to show up.”

“Shadow Weaver warned me that Glimmer would probably come around,” Adora said. She heard Catra grimace at her words.

“Would have been nice if she warned me too,” Octavia said. “And what the hell is *she* doing here?” She pointed at Catra. “You didn’t let her come, right?”

“I did not.” Adora looked at Catra and then back at Octavia. “I’ll deal with her when we get back to the Fright Zone.” Catra’s smug look faded.

“Good,” Octavia said. “I can take it from here if no more princesses show up. You go back and *deal* with her. She *really* gets on my nerves.” She glared daggers at Catra.

“Alright,” Adora said. “Thank you.”
“Whatever,” Octavia grunted. “Let’s go!” She beckoned her soldiers forward and they all followed her through the town.

“Adora…” Catra stepped forward.

“Catra,” Adora said. “We’re going home.”

“I’m sorry-”

“We’ll talk about this later,” Adora interrupted. “We’re going home. Now.”

Catra gulped. “Yes, Force Captain.”

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

Adora is *mad* at Catra; everybody seems to be lmao. Glimmer is really not having fun this chapter and that will absolutely *not* change in the future.

I really don't know what to say, honestly. I was very confident going into Tuesday night that Harris would win, but this overwhelming loss feels... empty? I am not going to stop uploading the chapters in this part, but I can't guarantee that part 2 and 3 will come. Sorry.

Comments are always appreciated!

Crimes of Passion

Chapter Summary

> Catra and Adora's first time. Filler content for those who want to skip smut.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra and Adora rode back to the Fright Zone in silence. The tank was mercifully less bumpy this ride. Adora just sat on a crate, looking at her sword in different angles of the dim light. Catra held onto one of the handles that were dangling from the ceiling. She couldn't tell how angry Adora was with her, and was too afraid to find out. It was nice to take a rest for a little while, even though she knew that whatever happened after they got back was going to be unpleasant, to say the least.

Shadow Weaver greeted them with a scowl as the door of the tank opened. Adora stood up and dragged Catra forward to meet her.

"What were you thinking?" Shadow Weaver shouted. "I can't believe you let Catra disobey my orders, Adora. You were *supposed* to keep an eye on her but you failed at that."

"She snuck onto a tank while you were training me," Adora said. "I didn't *let* her do anything. *I* told her to stay here. She chose to disobey orders of her own volition."

"You cannot lie to me to protect her, Force Captain," Shadow Weaver said.

"She's telling the truth," Catra said. "She told me to stay in her room."

“That’s interesting,” Shadow Weaver said. “Telling me that doesn’t benefit you in any way. This must be the truth.” She waved her hands and magical energy flickered at her fingertips. “I don’t know how many times I have to punish you but-”

“Enough,” Adora interrupted. “I’m doing it this time. She betrayed my trust, and I’m not letting her get off the hook.”

“Excellent,” Shadow Weaver said. “I’m so glad this new arrangement is working well.”

“Yeah, whatever.” Adora gritted her teeth and dragged Catra off to their room.

“Adora, I’m sorry, please-” Catra started.

“Shut up,” Adora growled. She threw Catra down on their bed.

Catra looked up at Adora with fear in her eyes. She whimpered.

“You know, Catra,” Adora said with a hint of anger in her voice. “I don’t actually know what I want to do. A part of me wants to hurt you like Shadow Weaver would, for betraying my trust like that.”

“Adora, I’m sorry,” Catra pleaded. “I wasn’t thinking when I snuck out, I never wanted t-”

Adora cut her off by forcefully placing her hand over Catra’s mouth. Catra felt a sudden warmth in her chest. Adora had never treated her like this before, and she was very confused as to how she felt about it.

“*But,*” Adora continued. “I could never hurt you like that. You mean too much to me, Catra. I love you.”

“I love you too,” Catra tried to say from under Adora’s hand, but it sounded more like “uh lud you tube.”

“Oh, sorry.” Adora lowered her hand. “I’m not going to punish you, Catra, not in any way that Shadow Weaver would do. But I’m

still really mad at you. You seriously betrayed my trust."

"I promise I won't do it again," Catra said. The fear that had been consuming her started to fade.

"Good." Adora sat down next to Catra on the bed. Now…" she hugged Catra tightly. "Thank you for saving my life today."

Catra hugged back. "Of course," she said. "What kind of girlfriend would I be if I let you get hurt like that?"

"Touché," Adora chuckled. She backed out of the hug. "Now, if Shadow Weaver ever asks…"
"I'll tell her that you scared the shit out of me and that I'll never do anything like that again," Catra finished.

"That works," Adora said.

"It's not technically wrong," Catra muttered.

"Oh shit," Adora said, hugging her girlfriend again. "Catra, I'm sorry. I didn't want it to go like that. I was just really mad."
"No, it's fine," Catra said. "You had to make it convincing for Shadow Weaver, right?"

"Yeah." Adora pulled back and kissed Catra on the cheek. "I'm still sorry though."

"So," Catra said. "Now that we have a bunch of free time, what do you want to do?"

"Oh, um," Adora coughed, blushing heavily. "I was thinking we could do *girlfriend* stuff together."
"What, like more making out?" Catra said, smirking. "I'm down."

"Um, no like…" Adora trailed off.

"What, do you wanna fuck me?" Catra smirked even harder, but blushing a little. "Who knew you were such a horn-dog, Adora?"

“I mean, I wouldn’t’ve put it exactly like that,” Adora chuckled, scratching the back of her head.

“What, were you going to say *engage in the activity of sexual intercourse?*” Catra teased, crudely imitating the uncomfortably formal voice from the terrible sexual education videos that they had been forced to watch as young teenagers.

“No, shut up,” Adora gently pushed Catra.”…maybe. Whatever! You’re ruining it.”

“Sorry!” Catra laughed. “You’re a massive dork and it’s adorable.”

“Thanks,” Adora said. “You’re adorable too.”

Catra blushed and looked away. “Thanks, Adora.”

“You’re welcome.” Adora reached for Catra’s face, pulled her in and kissed her. “Do you really want to?”

“Yeah,” Catra laughed. “I do.”

“Wait,” Adora said. “Aren’t we going to make a baby if we do this?”

Catra laughed. “Oh, Adora,” she said. “We’re not even the same species, it totally wouldn’t work. Plus,” she gestured at Adora’s crotch, which now had a slight bulge. “Remember what you told me after I caught you touching yourself in the showers at night? And those results from all those gross tests Shadow Weaver made you do?”

Adora made a small noise. “Yeah…” she said. “I do.”

“Yeah,” Catra chuckled. “I don’t think we’ll have to worry about that.”

“So, uh,” Adora said, blushing extremely hard. “What do we do first?”

"First we lock the door to make sure we don't get any *uninvited guests,*" Catra said. "Could you imagine Shadow Weaver walking in on us while…" she blushed. "You know…"

"What? While I'm sticking my cock inside you?" Adora asked. "Who's the dork now?"
"Shut up!" Catra hopped off the bed and walked over to the door to lock it. "You make this really hard, you know."

"No, I'm pretty sure you're the one making it hard." Adora smirked.

"Hm, clever," Catra said. She sat back down on top of Adora's lap and kissed her. She laid back down on the bed, limbs spread wide. "Can you just shut up and fuck me already?"

"Um, yeah." Adora leaned over Catra. "How do you want me to do that?"
"Preferably with less clothes on," Catra said, sticking her thumbs into the waistband of her leggings. "How else would you do it?"

"Oh, uh, yeah." Adora blushed. "But which clothes…?"

"Ugh," Catra groaned. "Let's just get naked and go from there."

"Okay!"

Adora and Catra both undressed themselves on the bed, blushing as they snuck in glances at one another. When they were finished, they sat on the bed awkwardly, unable to look at each other.

"So, uh, under the covers?" Adora asked.

"Under the covers," Catra hastily agreed.

Catra laid back down while Adora grabbed the covers and threw it over them.

Adora was above Catra with her hands placed on either side of her head. It was strange being like this; she had so much power

over her, so much control…

Adora shook her head and put that thought out of her mind. She wasn't here to punish Catra, but to celebrate the love they had for each other.

"Wow, you're really pretty," Adora said.

Catra blushed and looked away. "Yeah, thanks," she said. "You too."

Adora chuckled. She leaned down and kissed Catra's cheek. "I want you," she whispered in her ear.

"I want you too," Catra whined. "I've wanted you for so long. Please…"
"Please, what?" Adora asked.

"Just put it in!" Catra whined.

Adora nodded. She looked down at her erect cock, trying to guide it to where it was supposed to go. It was strange and unfamiliar to have it up against someone else, someone else who loved her. She found Catra's wet entrance with the tip of her cock.

Catra moaned.

"Oh shit," Adora whispered.

"What?" Catra snapped.

"You're so beautiful," Adora said. She delicately pushed herself into Catra, not too much, not even half of her cock. Catra felt so tight, like at any point she would reach a wall.

Catra moaned louder. "Fuck…"

Adora relaxed slightly and cupped Catra's face with one hand. She kissed her gently, letting her cock slide deeper into her.

"Adora, fuck!" Catra shouted.

“Huh? What?” Adora pulled back, slightly panicked. “Are you okay? What happened?”

“It’s just… too much,” Catra said. “Not that far in.”

“Oh, okay.” Adora nodded. “Can I…?”

“Please,” Catra whimpered.

“Yes…” Adora leaned back down and kissed Catra hungrily, letting herself slide back inside, but careful to not go far. She laid her body down on top of Catra, chests touching each other. It hurt slightly, but she wanted too badly to be close to Catra.

Catra wrapped her arms around Adora’s back and deepened their kiss. Adora could feel that she wanted her as much as she did herself.

“Let me take care of you,” Adora whispered into Catra’s ear.

“Yes, Adora,” Catra whined, desperation clear in her words.

“Good girl,” Adora said. She saw immediately that her words had set something off in Catra. She seemed more desperate for Adora now, more desperate for her touch. “Shit, okay,” she murmured under her breath.

Adora began slowly pushing herself in and out of Catra. She could tell they both needed more stimulation. She resumed kissing Catra, clasping her face in one hand, desperate for more of her.

“Adora, fuck, more,” Catra groaned.
“Of course,” Adora promised. She kissed Catra again and began to thrust harder and further. “You feel so good, Catra.”
Catra moaned and Adora moaned with her. This new sensation they were experiencing together was almost too intense.

Almost.

Adora could feel her orgasm building. She felt slightly disappointed as she never wanted this moment to end. She wanted Catra, she wanted for her to be *hers,* forever suspended in a perfect moment of love and bliss.

"Fuck," Adora moaned. "Catra, I'm close, are y-?"

"Yes!" Catra shouted. "Please, I need-"

"Yes, Catra," Adora cut her off. "Just a little more…" She thrusted harder into Catra. She felt more and more that she was about to erupt, about to spill all of herself out into Catra and give her all of her love.

"Adora!" Catra shouted. "Fuck…"

Adora could feel Catra tighten and her body buckle and collapse around her. She wanted to give Catra all of her love; she wanted to give her everything she could. She kept thrusting into her through her orgasm, keeping up the stimulation without release. She felt her climax begin as Catra's body loosened up again. She made a final thrust, not quite all the way in but still the deepest she'd made, and felt a wave of pleasure wash over her. It was more intense than anything she'd experienced by herself, as if her love for Catra made it stronger.

"Catra!" Adora shouted, closing her eyes. She felt her orgasm begin to fade as her cock ejaculated uselessly into Catra's pussy. Slowly, she pulled out and looked back down at Catra. "Fuck, I was not expecting *that.*"

"Yeah, me neither." Catra smiled. "I was totally expecting you to be a massive dork the entire time."

"Shut up," Adora said. She rolled over and laid down next to Catra, placing her arm around her. "You like that I'm a dork."

"Yeah." Catra blushed. "I do…"

"I love you," Adora said.

Catra looked back. “I love you too,” she said. “Dork.”

Adora chuckled. “I do feel a little gross,” she said. “I think I’m going to take a shower.” She sat up.

“Wow,” Catra said sarcastically. “I can’t believe that you think having sex with me is gross. You’re so hurtful.”

“You know that’s not I meant,” Adora said. She got out of bed and began walking toward her shower. “I loved it.”

“I loved it too.” Catra blushed, staring at Adora’s muscular back.

Adora turned around to face Catra. “I’d like to do it again sometime,” she said, smiling. “If you want to.”

“Yeah,” Catra said. “I think I’d like that.”

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

Happy six years of SPOP! That's actually crazy that it's been this long.

For the virgins reading this, this is not a realistic depiction of a first time. Do not be disappointed if it is nowhere close to as sexually satisfying for you as it was for these two idiots.

I wanted to hint at the toxic tendencies that these have at this point, but without them on full display as they will be later. This is basically a filler chapter so that's why I uploaded it a bit early. Plot chapter coming next time!

Comments are always appreciated!

Pirates and Princesses

Chapter Summary

> Catra and Adora meet a new friend. Glimmer and Bow meet two new friends

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Glimmer, are you okay?" Queen Angella asked. The sound was muffled by the thick metal doors between her and Glimmer.

"Yeah, I'm fine, Mom," Glimmer said. She had been saying that over and over again for the last day or so. She'd hoped that it would magically become true at some point.

Glimmer was sulking in her bed. She was upset, but unsure of what she was upset at. It could be herself, her mom, the Horde, She-Ra, that annoying cat lady who seemed to follow She-Ra around everywhere, or it could be all of them. The loss at Thaymor was infuriating her in every possible way.

"Bow's here to talk to you," Angella said. "Can he come in?"
"Ugh, fine," Glimmer said. "Send him in."

The door creaked open and Glimmer heard the delicate footsteps of Bow's boots walk forward.

"Hi, Bow," Glimmer said, not looking up from her bed.

"Hey, Glimmer," Bow said. "Do you wanna come down and talk?"

"Fine." Glimmer sat up and teleported down to the ground. She sat down at her desk and laid her head down in her crossed arms. "What do you want to talk about?"

"I want to talk about cheering you up," Bow said delicately.

“I already told you I’m fine,” Glimmer groaned. “I don’t need to be cheered up.”

“Sure,” Bow said. “But let’s say, for the sake of argument, that you weren’t fine and that you *did* need to be cheered up.”

“Sure,” Glimmer said. “What then?”

“Well,” Bow continued. “Wouldn’t it be awesome to receive some good news?”

“That would be exciting.” Glimmer sat back up and looked at Bow. “Do you have any?”

“As a matter of fact, I do!” Bow said excitedly.”Your mom has officially given us our next mission. We’re going to Salineas today to bring Princess Mermista to Brightmoon for a meeting.”

“Ooh, awesome!” Glimmer stood back up. “Let’s go now!” She ran over to Bow and grabbed him.

“Wait!” Bow shouted. “We have to-”

Glimmer cut him off by teleporting them both out of the room.

——

“Force Captain Adora, I want to commend you for your success at Thaymor yesterday,” Shadow Weaver drawled. “She-Ra has certainly proved to be most valuable to the Horde.”

“She barely did anything,” Catra said. She was sitting on Adora’s bed while the other two women stood in front of her. “She wouldn’t have been able to take out the Brightmoon princess if it weren't for me.”

“Silence, *Cadet!*” Shadow Weaver shouted, magic flaring. “You were not even supposed to *be* on that mission, so nothing you did there counts toward your accomplishments.”

“That’s not fa-” Catra started, but Adora silenced her by raising her hand.

“Thank you, Shadow Weaver,” Adora said.

“I see that your ability to discipline Catra is lacking, Force Captain,” Shadow Weaver said. “She should *not* be talking back to me when I address *you.*”

“Understood,” Adora nodded. “It’s…” She turned and looked back at Catra with a loving expression, but returned to a neutral one when she turned back to Shadow Weaver. “A lot. She’s a lot to deal with.”

“Now you understand how I feel,” Shadow Weaver said. “I’m sending you on your next assignment as a Force Captain, and as *She-Ra.* She should accompany you, I don’t want her to leave your sight.”

“I understand,” Adora said.

“Excellent,” Shadow Weaver said. “Meet Force Captain Scorpia in the briefing room in fifteen minutes, the details will be explained to you there.”

“Yes, Shadow Weaver” Adora said, saluting.

“Good.” Shadow Weaver turned and floated ominously out of the room, the door closing shut behind her.

“Yeah, your *discipline* skills need work, Adora,” Catra teased. She hopped up off the bed.

“Shut up!” Adora said. “It was our first time, I’ll get better.”

“If you want to get better,” Catra said, hugging Adora from behind. “You’ll have to *practice* more often.”

“I promise I will,” Adora said, shoving Catra off of her. “But right now we have to go to a meeting.”

“Ugh, you’re the worst,” Catra groaned. “Fine.”

Adora leaned over and kissed Catra on the cheek. “I love you too,” she said.

“Yeah, I guess.” Catra smirked, kissing her back.

Catra and Adora walked into the briefing room together. A large woman with short white hair was sitting on the benches. She had large, spiky pincers and a long, pointed tail. She looked kind of like a scorpion.

So that’s why she was named that, Catra thought. *Her parents were really unoriginal.*

“Oh, hi!” Scorpia said, standing up. “You must be Force Captain Adora!” She ran over and vigorously shook Adora’s hand. “It’s really great to meet you.”

“Uh, thanks?” Adora said. “You too.”

Scorpia turned to Catra. “Hi, what’s your name?”

“Hi,” Catra said. “I’m Catra.”

“Catra, ha!” Scorpia laughed. “I get it! That’s hilarious!”

“What’s hilarious?” Catra asked.

“Oh,” Adora chuckled. “I haven’t thought about it in a while, but that *is* kinda funny.”

“What?” Catra shouted.

“Sorry! Sorry,” Adora said. “I like your name, it’s cute.”

“Oh,” Scorpia said, blushing. “Are you two like…? You know.”

“Like what?” Catra asked, smirking.

“Uh, never mind,” Scorpia said.

“I see that introductions have gone well.”

All three of them jumped.

“Argh!” Catra shouted. “Hi, Shadow Weaver.”

“Hello, *Cadet,*” Shadow Weaver spat. “I’m glad you were able to attend this meeting instead of sneaking off again.”

“Yeah, well.” Catra crossed her arms. “Adora’s *discipline* seems to be working.”

“Clearly.” Shadow Weaver squinted her eyes. She turned to Adora and Scorpia. “You two are being sent to attack the Sea Gate at Salineas. Our reports indicate that it has been significantly weakened.”

“So what are we doing there?” Adora asked.

“You will *destroy it.*” Shadow Weaver clenched her fist. “That will give our forces the opportunity to invade and finally *conquer* Salineas.”

“Understood,” Adora said.

“You got it, boss!” Scorpia said excitedly.

“Excellent,” Shadow Weaver said. “With the power of She-Ra, Adora should be able to defeat the princess of Salineas, Mermista. This will give Scorpia’s forces the opportunity to destroy the Sea Gate.”

“She-Ra?” Scorpia asked. “That wasn’t in Force Captain orientation.”

“Force Captain orientation?” Adora asked.

“Adora is She-Ra,” Shadow Weaver explained. “A princess, like you, Scorpia.”

“Scorpia’s a princess?” Catra asked in bewilderment.

“Yes,” Shadow Weaver signed. “The Horde now has two princesses on its side, and She-Ra is the most powerful princess of all.”

“Wow, that’s cool,” Scorpia said.

“Indeed,” Shadow Weaver said. “It is *cool.* Now, gather your forces, Force Captains. Your ship leaves immediately.”

“Bow, this doesn’t look like Salineas,” Glimmer said. “This looks like a dive bar.”

“That’s because it *is* a dive bar,” Bow said. “A dive bar with sea captains! Sea captains that can take us *to* Salineas.”

“So what are we supposed to do?” Glimmer asked. “Just walk up to one of these obvious criminals and ask them to take us there?”

“Yep!” Bow said excitedly.

“You’re going to get us killed,” Glimmer groaned. “Or worse.”
“Where’s your sense of adventure, Glimmer?” Bow asked, walking around the bar.

“Did you say *adventure?*”

“Huh?” Bow and Glimmer turned around to see the voice. A man with a mustache wearing a blue jacket sat in the booth with his feet on the table.

"I *did* say adventure," Bow said. "Who are you?"

"There are some who call me… *Sea Hawk,*" the man said.

"Wow," Bow said. Glimmer could swear that he had sparkles in his eyes somehow.

"That's because it's my name," Sea Hawk laughed. "I couldn't help but overhear that you two are in need of a sea captain, and I can't help but *be* one."

Glimmer stepped forward. "We are," she said. "We're interviewing potential captains to take us to Salineas. Would you like to apply for the position?"

"Apply for the position?" Sea Hawk laughed. "I am the one and only Sea Hawk. I'm offer only."

"I've never heard of you, *Sea Hawk,*" Glimmer said. "Just because 'Sea' is in your name, doesn't tell us anything about your *actual* qualifications."

"Qualifications?" Sea Hawk stood up. "I once ran the fifty-klick Galebreath Gauntlet in less than twenty klicks. I maneuvered the straits of Serpentine with nary a chip in the paint of my bow. My shanties are considered so desirable, that sirens fling *themselves* into the sea at the sound of them." He looked at Bow. "…And because I can tell you're wondering, my mustache is…naturally shiny."

"It *is* shiny." Bow stared at Sea Hawk's mustache in awe. "You're hired." Glimmer elbowed him and stepped in front of him. "Ow."

"Woah there, kids," Sea Hawk said. "What makes you think you can *afford* me?"

"I assure you, Captain Sea Hawk," Glimmer said confidently. "Money is *no* object."

“Behold!” Sea Hawk reached into his shirt, pulled out a small, folded piece of paper and handed it to Glimmer. “My fee.”

Glimmer unfolded the paper and stared at it with Bow.

“That’s a *lot* of zeroes,” Bow said quietly.

Glimmer threw the paper down. “Money might be an object,” she said. “You know what, *fine.* We'll just find *another* sea captain.” She turned away.

“Good luck with that,” Sea Hawk taunted. “You won't find another soul who knows the treacherous route to Salineas as well as I do. I brave it often to visit my close, *personal* friend, Princess Mermista.”

“You know her?” Glimmer gasped.

“Uh, do I?” Sea Hawk asked. He looked like he’d been caught in a lie.

“Yeah, you just said that you did,” Bow said.

“*Ahem,* I do!” Sea Hawk said with renewed. confidence. “…And to prove it to you… I will take you to her *at once!*”

“Great!” Glimmer said. “For free?”

“Uh, we’ll work out the details later,” Sea Hawk said. “Now come, Shimmer!” He pulled in Glimmer with one hand.

“It’s *Glimmer,*” Glimmer said.

“That’s what I said.”

“Ugh.”

“Now come, Glitter!” Sea Hawk said. “Onward! To a glorious a*dventure!*”

“Ugh, now I wish we’d been killed,” Glimmer groaned.

"Behold!" Sea Hawk shouted. "The *Dragon's Daughter… III!*"

"What happened to the other two?" Glimmer asked.

"Tragically," Sea Hawk said. "They went down in flames."

"How did that happen?" Bow asked in awe. Glimmer could swear she could see those sparkles in his eyes again.

"I set them on fire," Sea Hawk said nonchalantly. He leaped onto the deck of his ship. "Now come!" he shouted, confidently. "*Adventure!*"

"I swear to fuck," Glimmer muttered.

"Why did Shadow Weaver make me go on a *boat?*" Catra groaned.

"I'm sorry." Adora wrapped an arm around her. "It's just for this mission."

"Yeah, but she's also going to make you come for the invasion of Salineas," Catra said. "And she's going to make me come with you so you can *keep an eye on me.*"

"I…" Adora started. "I don't know. We'll figure something out."

"You promise?" Catra asked.

"I promise."

"Thank you."

"So you two are pretty close, huh?" Scorpia walked up to the two of them.

"Yeah," Catra said. "You could say that."

"Cool, cool," Scorpia said. "I don't want to get in the way of… *anything* that you two have going on."

"You don't have to beat around the bush, Scorpia," Adora said. "Catra's my girlfriend. Just… don't tell anyone, *especially* Shadow Weaver, okay?"

"Yeah, yeah, totally," Scorpia said. "I'm great at keeping secrets! Like this one time, Kyle told me he had a crush on Rogeli- okay, never mind, just ignore that. Haha."

"Oh, we *all* already knew that," Catra laughed.

"*We did?*" Adora asked in bewilderment.

Catra slapped her forehead. "You're kind of an idiot sometimes."

"Haha, yeah," Scorpia said. "I just wanted to ask you… I mean, you two seem really nice and I was wondering if… you wanted to be friends… with me?"

"Yeah, sure!" Adora said. "We don't have many friends, just our squad we grew up with, really."

"Awesome!" Scorpia said excitedly. "Just so you know, I give *great* hugs! Come here!"

"Wait, hold on!" Catra said.

Scorpia reached with her massive arms and squeezed them both in a tight embrace, lifting them off the ground slightly. "Alright, new friends!" she said. "Now let's go destroy that Gate thingy! … Or whatever it was."

"Wow, you're pointy," Catra said.

"Ugh, why did you bring *him* here?" Princess Mermista moaned.

"I thought you said you were friends," Glimmer said to Sea Hawk.

"I didn't say that… *exactly,*" Sea Hawk said nervously. "I just said that I *knew* her."

"No, I'm pretty sure you said that she was your 'close, *personal* friend'," Bow said.

"Haha, we don't need to worry about pesky little details like that," Sea Hawk laughed. "What's important is that I got you to Salineas like I promised and now you will pay me my fee?"

"We are *not* paying you that much money!" Glimmer said. "You nearly got us killed! Three separate times!"

"Yeah, it was awesome," Bow said. He saw Glimmer's disapproving look. "I mean awful, totally awful!"

"Ugh, sounds about right," Mermista moaned. "What do you to want anyway?"

"Princess Mermista." Glimmer stepped forward and kneeled. "As a representative for the Great Brightmoon Rebellion and Queen Angella, I humbly ask you to come with us to Brightmoon for a meeting of the princesses." Bow kneeled behind her.

"Why would I do that?" Mermista asked.

"Because," Glimmer said. "The Horde has acquired the most powerful weapon in all of Etheria, the legendary warrior She-Ra."

"Yeah, right," Mermista said. "I'm supposed to believe that the mythical warrior, someone that no one has ever found definitive

proof of, prophesied to save us in our hour of greatest need, is coming to destroy us?"

"Unfortunately, I do," Glimmer said. "She was the one responsible for the devastation of Thaymor. I fought her myself. She is *definitely* real."

"Well, that's *fucking* amazing," Mermista said. "I can't just leave my kingdom defenseless though. If what you say is true, Salineas needs better defenses."

"Don't you have the indestructible Sea Gate?" Bow asked.

"Yeah, it's less 'indestructible' and more 'about to collapse," Mermista groaned. "It's so annoying."

"What?" Glimmer shouted. "Why didn't you say anything to Queen Angella?"

"Because she's *your* mom, not mine," Mermista said. "And I *thought* about asking you guys for help, but then I didn't."

"Well, if we can repair the Sea Gate, will you come with us to Brightmoon?" Bow asked.

"Ugh, fine," Mermista said. Her lone guard came up to her and whispered something in her ear. "Also, you need to do it right now because there's a Horde ship with a big gun on it coming toward us."

"WHAT!"

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

I decided to do the Mermista plot line first because (spoilers!) I'm not doing a section about recruiting Perfuma. We have more important things to focus on, like Scorpia! I realized here that my self imposed chapter length of 2,000 to 2,500

words was going to necessitate some sections being multi-parters, so that's why. It just really means uploads are more often!

Comments are always appreciated!

The Sea Gate

Chapter Summary

> Catra and Adora get separated. Catra attempts to murder a stripper.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Force Captain, we're approaching the Sea Gate."

"Good." Adora nodded to the soldier. "Tell the gunners to take aim and prepare to fire on my command."

"Yes, Force Captain." The soldier saluted Adora and ran off.

"Wow, you were so commanding," Scorpia laughed. "I've never gotten the hang of that. How long did you say you've been a Force Captain again?"

"Two days?" Adora laughed nervously.

"Don't sell yourself short." Catra nudged Adora. "It's been three *whole* days, Force Captain."

"Yeah, three," Adora laughed. "Shadow Weaver's basically been training me for this position since day one, even before *anyone* knew I was She-Ra."

"Wow, that's crazy," Scorpia said. "I guess I was always meant for this role too. They just put all their princesses in this position then, huh?"

"Yeah, I guess," Adora said. "Make sure you get your troops ready for the assault. The princesses of Salineas should be here any second and I can't help you when I'm fighting her."

“On it.” Scorpia saluted. She ran off across the deck, yelling orders at random soldiers.

“She has no idea what she’s doing, does she?” Catra asked.

“Yeah, I don’t know,” Adora said. “But she is nice, so you could try to be a little kinder to our new friend.”

“If you say so, *Force Captain,*” Catra mocked.

“How about ‘yes, my beautiful girlfriend whom I love’?” Adora suggested.

“That works too.” Catra leaned in and kissed Adora’s cheek. She turned and looked at a passing soldier who was staring. “What are you looking at?”

“Who? Me?” the soldier asked nervously.

“Get back to work, soldier,” Adora ordered.

“Uh, yes, sir!” the soldier saluted. “Uh, I mean, ma’am. Uh, sirma’amforcecaptain!” They ran off.

Adora and Catra both laughed.

“Newbie,” Catra chuckled. “It’s really hot when you order people around.”

“Thanks.” Adora couldn’t help but feel a sudden and unwelcome pang of dysphoria, one that was thankfully outweighed by the comedy of the situation. “You should get below deck soon. I really doubt you would want to help me fight the princess with water magic.”

“Yeah, no,” Catra said. “Be safe, okay?”

“I promise.”

“Good.” Catra turned to walk away. Before she could take a step, a puff of pink glitter appeared on the deck and Princess Glimmer

and a man in a blue jacket holding a glowing, yellow rapier that Adora hadn't seen before came out of it.

"Rebels on the deck!" someone shouted.

"Get them!" Scorpia ordered, pointing her claw at the pair.

"What the hell are you doing here, Sparkles?" Catra asked.

"I could say the same to you!" She sent a blast of magic at Catra, which she quickly dodged.

"Wait, where's the water princess?" Adora shouted.

The ship suddenly lurched to one side and everyone on board fell over.

"I think we know now!" Catra shouted.

"Shit!" Adora gritted her teeth. She grabbed her sword off her back and held it high. "*For the honor of Grayskull!*"

"Careful with the ship!" Bow said. "If She-Ra's sword falls in the ocean, we might never find it."

"Ugh, fine," Mermista groaned. "I'll *try* to be careful, but it's not exactly easy at this distance. Can't I just be on the ship with them?"

"Unfortunately, no," Bow said. "We need a princess at the gate in case anything goes wrong and, well, Glimmer can teleport so she got there first."

"This stupid plan doesn't make any sense," Mermista said. "Can you explain it again?"

“If my theory is correct,” Bow started. “The Sea Gate is made of First Ones’ tech, just like She-Ra’s sword. Her sword is said to have the power to heal people and technology, and if the legends are true, we can use it to fix the Sea Gate.”

“That’s a lot of ‘if’s’,” Mermista said.

“We don’t exactly have a lot of options,” Bow said exasperatedly. “I’m not exactly a First One’s engineer, so it’s not like I can fix it all by myself.”

“Ugh,” Mermista moaned. She raised her hand and a huge wave rose to stop an incoming laser blast.

“Any minute now, Glimmer should teleport over here with She-Ra’s sword,” Bow said.

“En garde!” the strange mustached man shouted. He pointed his sword at Catra.

“What are you supposed to be, some kind of stripper?” Catra taunted.

“I am the one and *only* Sea Hawk!” the man said confidently.

“Who?”

“Have you not heard of me?” Sea Hawk asked sheepishly, lowering his sword.

“Nope!” Catra leapt forward, swiping her claws at his face.

“Ah!” Sea Hawk raised his sword to block. Catra turned in midair, landed feet-first on the flat end, and jumped back, knocking him over.

"Where's your other friend, Sparkles?" Catra shouted at Glimmer, who was currently shooting a series of magical blasts at Adora, all of which she was avoiding. "This one seems pretty useless!"

"Argh! Who even *are* you?" Glimmer shouted. "She-Ra's annoying pet?"

A jolt of anger shot up Catra's spine. "No one calls me a pet!" She leapt for Glimmer, tackling her and causing her next blast to hit the large sail of the ship, searing a big hole in it.

"Ah! Get off me!" Glimmer kicked at Catra's face.

Catra lost her grip and fell back. "I'm someone who will make sure you don't hurt her!"

"Take that, fiend!"

Catra dodged Sea Hawk's incoming attack from behind. She stuck her foot out and tripped him, causing him to fall forward and drop his sword. "Oh crap," he said.

Catra walked over and picked up Sea Hawk's dropped sword. "I've always wanted to try one of these," she said. "Hey, Adora! I got one too!"

"Nice," Adora said.

"Aha!" Sea Hawk twirled his legs, sweeping her feet out from under her and causing the sword to once again fall to the deck. He stood up and retrieved his sword. "I said take *that!*" He pointed his sword at Catra.

"Don't hurt her!" Adora rushed forward toward Sea Hawk.

"Adora, I'm fine!" Catra shouted.

But Adora kept running. Glimmer reached out and grabbed Adora's leg, causing her to fall forward, but she teleported them both away before she could hit the deck.

“Adora!” Catra shouted, reaching for where she had just vanished.

“Looks like it’s just you and me now,” Sea Hawk said confidently.

“…And an entire ship’s worth of Horde soldiers,” Catra said, gesturing to the group of soldiers amassing behind her.

“Oh shit,” Sea Hawk chuckled. “I seem to have forgotten about that part, haha.”

Suddenly, Sea Hawk tensed up and fell down to the deck, face-first.

“Hi!” Scorpia said. “I stung him with my tail. Isn’t that cool?”

“And Scorpia,” Catra said. “What did that do to him?”

“He’ll be paralyzed for a few minutes,” Scorpia explained. She reached her claw out to Catra. Catra grabbed it and stood up. “What do you think we should do with him?”

“That sparkle princess took Adora,” Catra said. “Tie him up and we’ll use him for ransom to get her back, if we have to. If not, we can just throw him overboard.”

Glimmer appeared in a puff of pink smoke next to Bow. She wan’t holding She-Ra’s sword, but She-Ra’s ankle instead.

“What the hell did you do to me?” She-Ra shouted.

“Glimmer! You were supposed to get She-Ra’s sword, not *She-Ra!*” Bow shouted.

“I tried!” Glimmer panted. “It was *hard.*”

“Take me back to the ship!” She-Ra shouted. She grabbed Glimmer by the collar and lifted her up off the ground.

“Ah! Help!” Glimmer shouted.

“Drop her!” Bow drew his bow and nocked an arrow pointed directly at She-Ra.

A great wall of water slammed into She-Ra, sweeping her off her feet, forcing her to drop Glimmer, and slamming her face-first into a rock wall. She dropped her sword and turned into a much smaller woman wearing a red jacket.

“Ugh, why do I have to do everything,” Mermista groaned. She picked up the dropped sword. “What do we do with *this* now?”

“We need to take it to the floating platforms in front of the Sea Gate,” Bow said. “I think. There’s a circle in the center of the gate and I’m pretty sure that’s our target.”

“Okay, now what do we do with her?” She gestured to the unconscious woman that had just been She-Ra.

“We should probably tie her up and take her with us,” Glimmer said. “The Horde won’t fire their canons at us if they might hit her and we might need her for this plan to work.”

“Wait, what about Sea Hawk?” Bow asked.

“He’s still on the boat,” Glimmer said. “Why?”

“He’s alone on the boat?” Bow shouted. “Why did you leave him there?”
“So I could teleport out with She-Ra.” Glimmer shrugged.

“We can’t just leave him there!” Bow said. “He’s probably their prisoner now, we have to rescue him.”

“No, we don’t,” Mermista said. “He’ll annoy me a lot less if he’s stuck in a Horde cell.”

“Come on,” Bow said. “Glimmer, do you really want to leave him with the Horde?”

“Ugh, kinda?” Glimmer shrugged. “Either way, we have to do this first. We can rescue him *after* we fix the Sea Gate.”

“Fine,” Bow said.

Glimmer teleported the four of them to the floating rock right in front of the big circle on the Sea Gate. “Is this the right one now?” she panted.

“Yes,” Bow said. “Now, Mermista, I think you have to point the sword at the Sea Gate and then *something* should happen.”

“Ugh, I’m holding my trident,” Mermista groaned. “Make Glitter do it, she’s not holding anything.”

“It’s *Glimmer!*” Glimmer shouted. “Why is *everyone* getting that wrong today?”

“Mermista, you have to do it because of your connection to the Sea Gate,” Bow said. “Probably. I can hold your trident while you do it.”
“Ew, no,” Mermista said. “Only the rulers of Salineas are allowed to wield this sacred trident.”

“I won’t be wielding it,” Bow said sheepishly. “I’ll just be holding onto it for you for a little bit. I promise I won’t use it, okay?”
“Ugh, fine, whatever,” Mermista groaned. “Just give me the sword, genius.”

“Thank you.” Bow exchanged the sword for Mermista’s trident.

“Okay, so if I point this at the Sea Gate, it will fix it?” Mermista asked, examining the sword.
“I think so!” Bow gave her a thumbs-up.

“Great, that inspires *so* much confidence,” Mermista said. “Whatever.” She turned around and pointed the sword at the center circle on the Sea Gate. Nothing happened. “It didn’t work, genius.”
“I can see that!” Bow shouted.

Catra looked through a telescope at the shoreline surrounding the Sea Gate, hoping to see where Adora had been taken. Suddenly she noticed a puff of pink near the gate and looked up. Four people stood on a floating platform at the center of the gate, one of them was Adora, unconscious and tied up in ropes.

“Scorpia!” Catra shouted. “Tell them to stop firing at the Sea Gate! They’ve got Adora up there!”

“Oh, man!” Scorpia shouted. She turned to the cannons. “Stop firing! They’ve got a Force Captain prisoner up there!” The cannons stopped firing. “Okay, now what?”

“We have to exchange the prisoner for her,” Catra said glumly.

“Oh, that doesn’t sound too bad,” Scorpia said. “Why did you make that sound bad?”

“Because we also have to fight two *princesses* for her sword,” Catra said with gritted teeth. “And we can’t beat them *without* Adora’s sword.”

“Oh,” Scorpia said. “That’s bad. *Really* bad.”

"Nothing's happening, Bow," Glimmer said. "Why is nothing happening?"
"I can see that!" Bow shouted. "It's not like there's a manual for this that I can reference."

"What if we also need She-Ra?" Mermista asked. "We could give *her* the sword and see if that helps."
"That's a *terrible* idea, Mermista!" Glimmer said. "She's try to kill us!"
"Oh, yeah," Mermista said. "She was so glowy and sparkly that I kind of forgot about that."

"No, wait, Mermista's right," Bow said.

"Bow, are you crazy?" Glimmer shouted.

"No," Bow said. "What if She-Ra was in contact with the sword, or indirect contact through a princess? Could that work?"

"Yeah, maybe," Mermista said. "It's not like any of us know how this works, anyway."

"Great!" Bow said excitedly. "Let's try it. Mermista, you hold the sword up to the gate and I'll hold *her* up to you."

"Fine," Mermista said. "But this better be quick, my arms are already tired."

"How? Glimmer asked. "It's been like two seconds."

"I'm just built different," Mermista shrugged, flipping her hair.

"Built worse," Glimmer muttered.

"Let's just do this," Bow sighed.

“Fine.” Mermista turned around and held the sword forward. Bow picked up the still-unconscious She-Ra and held her to Mermista. A blue beam of light shot out from the sword to the circle on the Sea Gate. The holes and cracks in the gate slowly began to fill, and the color of the wall began to return.

“It’s working!” Bow said excitedly. “Keep at it, Mermista.”

“That’s what I’m *doing,* genius,” Mermista groaned.

Catra could see the blue glow coming from the Sea Gate. She looked through her telescope and saw the princesses using Adora’s sword to shoot a weird energy beam at it.

“Scorpia, we have to go now!” Catra shouted. “They’re using Adora’s powers to repair the Sea Gate, we have to get her back before they can finish!”

“Oh, dang!” Scorpia said. She turned to the crew. “Full steam ahead to the Sea Gate, crew!” She turned back to Catra. “I like saying that, ‘full steam ahead.’ It’s really fun to say.”

“I’m glad you’re having fun, Scorpia,” Catra said. “But my *girlfriend* is currently being held hostage by the enemy, so can we *please* focus on that?”

“Yeah, yeah, no, totally,” Scorpia said. “We’re getting Adora back, totally.”

“I can’t believe that worked!” Glimmer said after she teleported them back down to the shoreline.

“Yeah, me neither,” Bow said.

“Remind me to never make plans with you two again,” Mermista said. “Also, that Horde ship is coming right at us.”

“What!” Bow and Glimmer turned around to see the massive Horde ship coming to a stop right next to the shore.

“Hey, rebels!”

The three of them turned their heads up to see a very angry looking magicat shouting at them.

“Give us back She-Ra *and* her sword,” the magicat shouted. “Or this weird stripper guy walks the plank!” She gestured to a tied-up, nervous-looking Sea Hawk being forced out onto a platform right over the sea.

“Don’t do it, Mermista, my beloved!” Sea Hawk shouted. “I’m not worth She-Ra!”

“Yeah, you’re right!” Mermista shouted. “Make him drown. I don’t care!”

“You weren’t supposed to say that!” Sea Hawk complained. “You’re supposed to save me!”

“Nah, I’m good,” Mermista said. “You’d be a lot less annoying when you’re at the bottom of the ocean.”

“Last chance!” the magical shouted. “Do you really not care about this guy?”

“I care about you, Sea Hawk!” Bow shouted.

“Give me back She-Ra now or he dies!” the magicat shouted. “Three!”

“Just throw him overboard and get it over with,” Mermista groaned. “This is not even close to tempting!”

“Two!”

“Are you serious?” Bow asked. “You’re just going to let him drown?”

“One!”

“Yes,” Mermista said.

“Throw him off!”

The horde soldier behind Sea Hawk pushed him off the plank. Screaming, he splashed into the ocean. Mermista raised her hand and a great wave of water pushed the Horde ship back out to sea and dragged Sea Hawk to shore.

“I couldn’t really let him drown,” Mermista said. She lifted Sea Hawk up off the beach and dusted him off.

Sea Hawk coughed up ocean water and sand. “I knew it!” he said. “It was all just an act.”

“…Not when I can throw him in my dungeon *myself,*” Mermista finished.

“Remind me never to get rescued by you,” Bow said.

“Trust me,” Mermista said. “It would never happen. Now, what are we going to do with *her*?”

The four of them turned to the still-unconscious She-Ra.

“We’re going to take her back to Brightmoon,” Glimmer said. “I’d love to have a nice, long chat with her.”

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

I realized when I wanted to adapt this section of that show that I could not have Adora win here, even though she absolutely could, because then I couldn't have the plot I wanted happen. So that's why Adora might have felt a little weak this chapter. I'm very excited to explore this version of Adora as a prisoner in Brightmoon. Spoilers, she's not going to decide to stay.

Comments are always appreciated!

Flowers for She-Ra

Chapter Summary

> Adora tries and fails to eat healthy. Perfuma tries and fails to give her therapy.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"**Adora, you must wake up.**"

"Huh?" Adora looked around. She was in the strange unreality with the weird woman again. *Light Hope, that's her name, right?*

"**They have taken the sword, Adora,**" Light Hope said. "**You must reclaim it before it's too late.**"

"Too late?" Adora asked. "What are they going to do with it?"

"**Unfortunately, I do not know.**" Light Hope shook her head. "**But they do not trust you and are willing to do whatever it takes to steal your power.**"

"So what do I do?" Adora asked frantically.

"**Find the sword.**" Light Hope's eyes glowed bright white, overwhelming everything else in the dream, and Adora could feel herself regaining consciousness.

Adora woke up in an unfamiliar place. The ceilings were high, the door was framed in an arch, and she could distinctly hear the sound of running water. She was sitting on a soft chair, something she didn't know existed. She wanted to melt into it, but her

training told her to remain vigilant. She was inside a glowing blue circle, likely something magical. She reached for the air outside the circle, but an invisible wall blocked her. Clearly, she was a prisoner, but she wasn't being held in something that looked like a prison.

The large double doors in front of her and a woman that Adora recognized as Queen Angella of Brightmoon stepped through, followed by a woman in a purple dress and a golden halo that she didn't recognize and Princess Glimmer.

"So, you're awake," the Queen said. "I'd like to ask you a few questions, if you don't mind."

"I'm not spilling all the Horde's secrets, if that's why you're asking," Adora said. "They trained me better than that."

"I'm sure they have," the Queen said. "I'd just like to get to know you, actually. What is your name?"

"A-" Adora stopped herself. "I thought you already knew that, I'm She-Ra."

"Hm," the Queen said. "Do you know who I am?"

"You're Queen Angella of Brightmoon," Adora said. "What is this, a quiz?"

"No, it is not," the Queen said. "What we are doing is trying to figure out this whole situation, why you are here."

"I'm here to save Etheria," Adora said. "The princesses bring chaos to this world and I am here to bring order."

"I'm sure you believe that," the Queen said. "What I meant is that all of our legends and stories say that you, *She-Ra,* would appear to save us in our hour of greatest need."

"Your stories were wrong," Adora said.

“It appears they were,” the Queen said. “I am curious about how you ended up with the Horde.”

“Like I’d tell you,” Adora said, crossing her arms. “Do you mind if I ask you a few questions?”

The Queen sighed. “I suppose not,” she said. “Although I can’t guarantee that I will answer them. I’m sure you understand.”

“I do.” Adora nodded. “Is this supposed to be a prison?”

“It is,” the Queen said. “Why does everyone keep asking that?”

“It sounds like it’s not,” Adora smiled.

“Fine, it’s the spare room,” the Queen said in a huff. “We don’t have an actual prison here so we had to improvise.”

“Not like you’ll be able to escape anyway,” the strange woman said. “That circle is impenetrable, not even She-Ra could break through it.”

“Oh, yeah, where’s my sword?” Adora asked.

“We are *not* going to tell you that,” the Queen said.

“Fine.” Adora slumped in the chair. “How did I get here? The last thing I remember was fighting at Salineas.”

“You were knocked out during the battle and we took you back here,” Glimmer said.

“Yeah, but how?” Adora asked. “I totally beat you last time.”

“Mermista hit you with a wave of water and you banged your head on a rock,” Glimmer said. “It was pretty embarrassing for you.”

Adora rubbed her forehead and scowled at Glimmer, who stuck her tongue out at her.

“Yes, I am just as shocked about that as you must be, She-Ra,” the Queen said. “You are supposed to be the strongest princess of all, how were you defeated so easily.”

“Maybe I was just taking it easy on you,” Adora said. “Maybe I wanted to get kidnapped. I’ll never tell.”

“Oh, I doubt that very much,” the Queen said. “From what I’ve seen, you seem to have somehow obtained the power of She-Ra quite recently, and are not very good at using it.”
Adora gulped. “So what if that’s true?” she said. “Which it’s not,” she added hastily.

“I could mean that you are an impersonator,” the Queen said. “A fake created by the Horde to scare us into submission. The *real* She-Ra could be out there somewhere, the Horde could have kidnapped her and stolen her power, then given it to you.”

“Yeah, that’s definitely not it,” Adora chuckled. “Shadow Weaver seemed just as surprised as everyone else that I was She-Ra.”

“Shadow Weaver,” the woman gasped. She turned to the Queen and Glimmer. “My brother’s old mentor. She betrayed the sorcerer’s guild for the Horde and now she must be training her. She always had a knack for stealing others’ power.”

“That’s certainly some useful information you’ve given us,” the Queen said, turning back to Adora. “I would very much like to continue this conversation another time. Let’s go.”

The three women turned and left the room, the double doors shutting behind them.

Shit! Adora thought. *That was careless. How the hell am I going to get out of here? I miss Catra. I hope she can rescue me soon.*

Some time later, Glimmer entered the room holding a plate of… something.

“What is that?” Adora asked.

“It’s dinner,” Glimmer said.

“That doesn’t look like ration bars,” Adora said. “What kind of food is that?”

“It’s called vegetables,” Glimmer said. “Have you never had those before?”
Adora shook her head. “What are those?”

“How are you alive?” Glimmer asked.

“Ration bars have all the nutrients a soldier needs,” Adora said. “Protein, calcium, protein, vitamins, protein, and… protein!”

“What the fuck…” Glimmer muttered. “Anyway,” she pushed the plate through the barrier. “Just eat it, I promise it’s not poison.”

“How can I be sure?” Adora asked.

“I guess you can’t,” Glimmer said. “But if you ask me, you’re much more valuable us alive right now than dead. Also, my mom really doesn’t like the idea of killing prisoners.”

“No wonder you guys are losing the war,” Adora said. She grabbed the plate and examined what was on it. “This is a leaf, I know that you can’t eat these.”

“It’s not a normal leaf,” Glimmer said. “If I wanted to kill you, I would be blasting you with magic blasts while you’re weak like this!”

“I am not weak!” Adora shouted.

“Fine, whatever,” Glimmer sighed. “Just eat something before you starve to death.”

Slowly, Adora picked up the the leaf thing and took a bite of it. She spat it out quickly. “Why does it taste so weird?”

“It tastes normal to me,” Glimmer said.

“You eat weird food here,” Adora said. “I miss home.”

“What, the Fright Zone?” Glimmer asked.

“Yeah,” Adora said. “That’s where I live.”

“What’s it like?” Glimmer asked.

“I don’t know, normal, I guess?” Adora said. “You have to follow a lot of rules, but it’s a lot less strict when you’re a Force Captain.” She tapped the rank pin on her chest.

“What, you miss that it’s less strict now?” Glimmer asked.

“No,” Adora sighed. “There are…” she blushed. “Other reasons.”

“Oh my god, are you dating that annoying cat lady?” Glimmer asked.

“Her name is Catra,” Adora said. “And…” She was blushing very heavily. “Yes. I really miss her.”

“I’m sorry,” Glimmer said.

“Are you?” Adora asked, her voice filled with suspicion.

“Honestly, I don’t know,” Glimmer said. “I do feel bad that you miss your girlfriend, but I’m also glad that you’re a prisoner in here and not fighting us out there.”

“Thanks, I guess?” Adora said.

“Don’t mention it,” Glimmer said. “Enjoy your dinner.” She teleported out of the room in a pink puff.

The next day was mostly uneventful. Adora sat in silence, interrupted only by guards dropping off meals, none of which were interested in having a conversation like Glimmer had been. Not that Adora had started one with them anyway.

“Here she is.”

The double doors opened and the Queen walked in, this time followed by a blonde girl in a pink dress.

“Hi, I’m Perfuma.” The girl waved.

“You’re the princess of the Kingdom of Plumeria,” Adora said. “I’ve read about you.”

“Yes, that’s me,” Perfuma said. “Queen Angella asked me to talk to you, is that okay?”

“You can talk to me all you want,” Adora said. “I’m not exactly in a position to stop you.”

“Yes, that’s true,” Perfuma said. She turned to the Queen. “Is there really no way for her to be free for this? I really don’t want this to feel like an interrogation.”

“I’m afraid not,” the Queen said. “She’s too dangerous. The second we let the barrier down, she’ll probably try to escape and reclaim her sword.”

“I understand,” Perfuma said. “Thank you, your majesty.”

“Of course, Perfuma,” the Queen said. She walked out of the room and the doors shut behind her.

“I’m sorry,” Perfuma said. “I really would have preferred that you not be imprisoned for this, but it appears that it is out of my hands.”

“The Queen was right,” Adora said. “I would have tried to escape.”

“Fair enough.” Perfuma sighed.

“Why are you here anyway?” Adora asked.

“In addition to being a princess, I’m also a mental health specialist,” Perfuma said. “My job is to work with my patients to make sure that they live happy lives.”

“What, are you going to cut open my head and rewire my brain so that I’m on your side?” Adora asked.

“The fact that that was a genuine question is not a good sign,” Perfuma said. “I do not operate on anyone’s brains, She-Ra. I talk with them so I can help them work out their problems.”

“My biggest problem right now seems to be that I’m trapped in here.” Adora tapped on the barrier and little ripples of blue magic emanated from where she touched.

“Yes, what do you want to do if you get out of here?” Perfuma asked.

“*If?*” Adora said.
Perfuma said. “I’m sorry,” she said. “What do you want to do *when* you get out of here?”

“Get my sword and go home,” Adora said. “Then win the war for the Horde. What else did you expect?”

“I expected as much,” Perfuma admitted. “What is home for you?”

“Glimmer asked me this yesterday,” Adora groaned, slumping in the chair. “The Fright Zone, it’s not that difficult to figure out.”

“What makes the Fright Zone your home?” Perfuma asked.

“Because I live there,” Adora said. “You are so much worse at interrogating people than the Queen. Even she didn’t ask

questions this stupid."

"This isn't an interrogation, She-Ra," Perfuma said. "I'm trying to help you."

"Even if I believe you," Adora said. "Which I don't, why would you, a *princess,* help me?"

"I want to help everyone," Perfuma said. "Seeing people like you in distress makes me sad."

"I'm only in distress because I'm a prisoner," Adora groaned. "If you really want to stop that ,you'd let me out."

"I don't think that's true," Perfuma said. "I believe that there's something else causing you a lot of distress that you might not have even realized yet."

"Oh, yeah?" Adora asked. "Like what?"

"That's what I'm trying to figure out," Perfuma said.

"Oh, so you're trying to figure out my weaknesses then, huh?" Adora said. "Well, it's not happening."

"That's not what I meant," Perfuma said. "Please, believe me, the last thing I want is to deceive you."

"I find that hard to believe," Adora said, crossing her arms.

"I'm sure you do," Perfuma said. "You've been taught to distrust princesses, haven't you?"

"Of course I have," Adora said. "You're violent instigators who do nothing but sow chaos and dissent."

"She-Ra, be honest, do I look like I'm trying to sow chaos?" Perfuma asked.

"No," Adora scoffed. "But that's just what you want me to think so I let my guard down and give you the opportunity to destroy me."

Perfuma sighed. “I can’t help someone who doesn’t want to be helped.”

“I don’t want what you call ‘help’,” Adora said.

“What do you want?” Perfuma asked.

“To get out of here!” Adora stood up and slammed her fist against the barrier. “Have I not made that clear?”

“You have,” Perfuma said. “I really hoped that this conversation would be more productive. I really did, She-Ra. I really hoped we could’ve reached a mutual understanding.”

“I understand well enough,” Adora said, leaning against the barrier. She could feel the slightest bend in its shape as she did so. She was angry and could feel adrenaline coursing through her. “You people fear me, fear my power. I know what manipulation looks like, I’ve seen it my whole life. You people want to use me as a weapon to destroy your enemies, the Horde does too. You both know I have the power to destroy, but neither of you could imagine that I could possibly have the power to choose for myself. I know what I’ve chosen and whom I fight for, and I don’t fight for you.” She thumped her fist against the barrier again and felt the slightest bend again. She looked down and saw that she was surrounded by glowing magical energy, not from the barrier, but from herself. She smiled.

Perfuma had a terrified look plastered across her face. Adora had clearly struck a nerve with her.

“Who do you fight for, the Horde?” Perfuma asked.

Adora laughed. “You people would never understand,” she said. “You only see sides in this war and not the people who fight it. You princesses are all the same, selfish bastards.” She hammered her fist on the barrier again and felt it almost give way to her strength.

“How are you…?” Perfuma’s voice faded.

“Your *Queen* speculated that I might be a fake She-Ra,” Adora laughed. “A deception meant to confuse the rebellion. It seems that she was too scared to admit that my power could possibly be used against her, that she could be on the wrong side of destiny.”

“Queen Angella!” Perfuma shouted.

The double doors burst open. The Queen, Glimmer, and the same strange woman from earlier rushed in, but froze in their tracks almost immediately.

“How is this possible without the sword?” the strange woman asked.

“I don’t know,” the Queen said, a horrified look on her face.

Adora laughed. “You were so confident when you thought I couldn’t bypass this barrier,” she said. “But now you’re all scared, scared that I can’t be controlled, that I can’t be your *weapon.*” She hammered against the barrier with both hands, she could feel that it was about to collapse.

“Who are you *really?*” the Queen asked.

“I told you,” Adora said. “I’m *She-Ra.*” She slammed on the barrier one last time and felt it completely give way. The circle beneath her and the entire barrier disappeared. “Where is my sword?”

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

I always loved the spare room being the Brightmoon prison, it made me laugh every time. I do think that Perfuma would genuinely try to help Adora here, she's not a manipulative person. I also think that Adora would totally see it that way because Shadow Weaver is a terrible person. Adora is starting to awaken her She-Ra powers without using the sword and Light Hope would really prefer if that *didn't* happen.

Comments are always appreciated!

The Honor of Grayskull

Chapter Summary

Catra's worried about Adora. Adora gets real mad.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"We *have* to go back for her!" Catra said. "We cannot let them *win.*"

"I'm sorry," Scorpia said. "But we've been pushed too far off course, and we barely have enough fuel to get back to the Fright Zone."

"No!" Catra shouted. She tried to charge Scorpia but two soldiers grabbed her arms and held her back. "Why are you leaving her?"

"I have no choice," Scorpia said solemnly. "We'll get her back soon, I promise."

"Your promises mean nothing to me!" Catra shouted. "Do you know what Shadow Weaver will do to me if I come back without Adora? She'll kill me!"

"Catra, please," Scorpia said. "There's nothing we can do. I'm sorry."

Catra felt her knees give out. She crumpled and the soldiers that were holding her back let go. She fell to the ground on all fours, feeling tears starting to well up in her eyes. "Why?" she whimpered to no one in particular. She punched the metal deck of the ship. Her hand started to hurt but she didn't care. Everything she cared about had just been taken by the enemy and she had no way to get her back.

"**Find the sword, Adora.**" Light Hope's voice rang in Adora's head, or was she still talking to her? The voice sounded so real, not at all like a memory of it.

Adora could see the four women in the room talking, but the magical energy surrounding her was drowning out the noise. They seemed panicked, and it was understandable why. None of them believed that she could break through the barrier, even Adora didn't believe it.

"Where is my sword?" Adora said, her voice ringing in her own head. It sounded like she was underwater, like the entire world was being drowned out by waves.

Adora took a step forward. The sound of her boot hitting the tile rang in her ear. Two more steps, she was out of where the circle used to be.

The woman in purple waved her hands. Magical circles formed around them and great, glowing, blue chains sprouted from the ground and bound Adora's hands.

Adora struggled against the chains but quickly broke through them, making them disappear into the thin air they had been created from. "Is that all you got?" Adora taunted, raising her fists.

The Queen and Glimmer both sent magical blasts at Adora from different directions. Adora ducked and charged at the Queen, attempting to tackle her. The Queen sent a powerful blast at Adora, but she crossed her forearms in front of her to block, causing her to slow down.

Adora tackled the Queen, sending them both crashing into the wall. Adora grabbed the Queen's collar and used it to lift her head up slightly. "Where is my sword?" Adora shouted, holding her fist in front of the Queen's face as a threat.

Adora suddenly felt her free hand being pulled back at the wrist. She turned her head and saw that a vine had wrapped itself around her forearm. She was suddenly yanked back and thrown against the opposite wall with a great crash. She fell to the ground, spitting out a few drops of blood.

Adora stood up and wiped the blood off her lips. "Looks like the flower girl has a few tricks too, huh?"

"**The sword is in the meeting room, two floors down.**"

Adora clutched her head with both her hands as Light Hope's harsh voice rang in her head. *Was that real, or did I imagine it?*

Adora sprinted for the door, arms poised to punch anyone that stood in her way. She swatted away numerous magical blasts coming from the Queen, Glimmer, and the woman in purple.

Glimmer stood in front of the door, hands up as if to surrender. Adora wasn't interested in accepting surrenders right now, so she kept charging. She hit Glimmer shoulder first, knocking her into the double doors and slamming them open. Glimmer fell to the ground but Adora kept going. The two guards who were on the other side of the door shouted something she couldn't hear and tried to chase her, but she was too far ahead.

"Glimmer, are you all right?" Queen Angella asked. She reached out her hand.

"Yeah, I'm fine." Glimmer grabbed her mother's hand and stood up. "What's going on with her. How is this happening without the sword?"

"It appears that She-Ra is more powerful that we could have imagined," Angella said.

“And now she’s loose in the castle,” Aunt Casta said. “Who knows what kind of damage she could do here.”

“Precisely,” Angella said. “Which is why we have to let her go.”

“What?” Glimmer shouted. “Mom, you can’t be serious!”

“I’m afraid I am,” Angella said. “We cannot defeat She-Ra, only delay the inevitable. And delaying her would mean even more destruction. Our best option is to let her go and try to minimize the damage she does on her way out.”

“If you expect me to just give up and let her walk out of here, you’re crazy, Mom!” Glimmer said.

“Glimmer!” Angella knelt down and put her hands on her daughter’s shoulders. “Lives are at stake here! I’m sorry, but this is the only way. We were foolish to think we were strong enough to hold her, and it would be even more foolish to think we could defeat her here. I’m not asking you to give up, I’m asking you to save lives.”

“Fine,” Glimmer said.

“Thank you, Glimmer.” Angella stood back up. “Our primary goal is to evacuate the castle. Once we do that, we must direct She-Ra out of Brightmoon to prevent her from doing more damage. Do you all understand?”

Glimmer, Castaspella, Perfuma, and the two guards nodded.

“Now go!” Angella ordered. “All of Brightmoon is at stake!”

Castle Brightmoon was a labyrinth. Light Hope had told her where the sword was, but that information wasn’t the most helpful when

she didn’t know how to get there. She had to go down two stories and had yet to find a single set of stairs, up or down.

“Agh!” Adora punched the nearest wall in frustration, leaving a large crack.

“She-Ra!”

Adora turned to the sound. It was barely audible over the sound of the magical energy surrounding her. She saw Perfuma slowly walking toward her with her hands raised, also almost a surrendering motion.

“What do you want?” Adora said.

“I just want to help you,” Perfuma said.

Adora laughed. “You tried that already and I didn’t want it,” she said. “Give me one good reason not to punch you in to that wall.”

“I will take you to your sword,” Perfuma said. “If you promise to leave here without hurting anyone.”

“You’ll take me to the meeting room?” Adora asked.

“How did you know?” Perfuma asked, stunned.

“None of you understand my power at all, do you?” Adora began to walk toward Perfuma. “I’m more pow-”

“**Do not trust her.**” Light Hope’s voice rang in Adora’s head. “**She is attempting to deceive you.**”

Adora staggered backward, clutching her head.

“Are you okay?” Perfuma reached out her hand. “Do you need help?”

“I don’t need whatever *help* you think you can give me,” Adora snapped. “Will you take me to the sword?”

"Only if you leave Brightmoon without hurting anyone," Perfuma said.

"**Do not go with her, she wants to steal your power.**"

"What's the catch?" Adora asked.

"What?" Perfuma looked confused. "There is no catch. We want you to leave as much as you do."
"You seemed perfectly happy to keep me here," Adora laughed. "Do you think I'm stupid? What changed?"

"Everything's changed!" Perfuma shouted. "You are stronger than we possibly could have imagined. We just want to prevent you from hurting anyone."

"**Adora, it's a trap. Do not go with her.**"

"If you try anything funny, I'll fucking kill you," Adora warned. "That goes for every other *princess* in this castle."

"I understand." Perfuma nodded.

"Now take me to my sword," Adora said.

"**You are making a mistake. Do not fall for their trap.**"

"Shut up!" Adora screamed, clutching her head. "Get out of my head!"

"Are you okay?" Perfuma asked. There was genuine concern on her face.

"I'm fine!" Adora shouted. "Just take me to the sword."

Perfuma slowly led Adora to the meeting room. The further they went, the more Adora was convinced that Brightmoon Castle had been deliberately constructed to be as confusing as possible. Light Hope's voice was shouting at her the entire time to turn back and to not trust the princesses, but she did her best to ignore it.

Perfuma pushed open a pair of doors and they stepped through. Adora was met with a long table surrounded by tall chairs. In the middle of the table was her sword. Behind the table was the Queen, Glimmer, the woman in purple, and several guards.

Adora stopped and looked at all of the people in the room with her. None of them spoke; they all just stared at her. Even Light Hope's voice had stopped. It was like the entire world was holding its breath, waiting for her to move.

Adora slowly walked over to the table. She looked at the people behind it and then back down at the sword. She saw her reflection it in. Her eyes were glowing so bright she couldn't see her irises or pupils anymore. Her ponytail had even come undone, not that it mattered much since her hair seemed to float away from her face.

Adora reached down and grabbed the sword. The instant she touched it the magical energy surrounding her vanished, her hair even fell back down in her face. The sudden silence seemed to hit her like she had hit a rock wall again. She looked up in a panic. Was this the trap Light Hope had warned her about? But everyone in the room seemed to be just as surprised as her and none of them made a move. She lifted the sword off the table and placed it on her back.

"She-Ra, I'd be happy to escort you to the exit, if you don't mind," Perfuma said. She was still standing by the entrance to the room.

"Thank you, Perfuma." Adora stared at the entourage in the room for a few more seconds before turning around and walking out of the room.

Perfuma led Adora quickly to the front gates of Brightmoon Castle, seemingly without any detours. Perfuma stood by the doors as Adora walked out.

"I'm very sorry we held you captive," Perfuma said.

"Thank you," Adora said, not looking back at her. "You're not like the others. I can't explain it, but I feel something different about you."

"I get that a lot," Perfuma said.

"I believe you," Adora said.

"…That I get that a lot?" Perfuma asked, confused.

"Well, yes," Adora said. "But I meant that I believe you were trying to help me. So, thank you."

"Oh, you're welcome," Perfuma said.

Adora turned her head and nodded to her. "Part of me hopes we meet again, princess."

Adora quickly realized that she was lost. She didn't know what she expected, but the Whispering Woods was just another labyrinth. She knew that the Fright Zone was South-ish, but that didn't really help when she couldn't tell which way *was* South.

"**Adora.**"

Adora clutched her head and fell to her knees as Light Hope's voice rang out in her mind. "What?" she shouted. "You were wrong, it wasn't a trap!"

"**It appears that I was,**" Light Hope said. "**I'm sorry. I could only see things from your perspective, and to me it seemed like a trap.**"

"What do you want now?" Adora asked. "I got the sword back, I just want to go home."

"**You cannot return to the Fright Zone,**" Light Hope said. "**You must come to me.**"

"If you think I'll just give up everything I've ever known and go live with you, then you're crazy!" Adora shouted. "I don't even know where you are!"

"**I will guide you to me,**" Light Hope said. "**Just follow your instincts.**"

"Let me go home!" Adora shouted. She drew her sword and started swiping it around wildly, hoping to hit something that wasn't there.

"**I am quite safe from the reach of that sword, Adora,**" Light Hope said. "**You must learn to control your power. Otherwise, you will cause pain and suffering beyond measure.**"

"And you'll teach me?" Adora asked.

"**Yes.**"

"Will you let me leave if I wish to?" Adora asked.

"**You will be able to return to the Fright Zone in time,**" Light Hope said.

"How much time?" Adora asked, a hint of suspicion in her voice.

"**The training takes years,**" Light Hope said.

"Oh, fuck that," Adora said. "I'm not becoming another prisoner."

"**Fine, you may come and go as you wish,**" Light Hope said. "**But I implore you to stay as long as you can.**"

"Fine," Adora said. "Where are you?"

"**Turn around.**"

"Huh?" Adora turned her head and saw a glowing light in the distance. It reminded her of the same light she had seen when she had retrieved the sword. Slowly and carefully, she walked toward it. She came to a clearing, in the center of which was a massive crystal tower; the top of the tower was a glowing beacon. "What the fuck?"

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

Light Hope is getting really anxious about Adora potentially being about to use her powers without the sword. I know we don't actually know if Adora can use her powers without the sword while the sword exists, but I think she probably could. Adora's too powerful for Light Hope to control but neither of them have realized it yet. More conflict in the next issue!

Comments are always appreciated!

Light Hope

Chapter Summary

Adora talks to Light Hope. Shadow Weaver punishes Catra.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Hello?" Adora said. Her voice echoed throughout the clearing.

"**I am inside,**" Light Hope said.

Adora walked forward. The architecture was strange; it looked nothing like the Fright Zone or any of the other places she had been recently. It was angular and crystalline, with no signs of practical utilities like vents or pipes. "What is this place?" Adora said.

"**The Crystal Castle, my home,**" Light Hope said. "**This place was meant to train She-Ra.**"
"This place was meant for me?" Adora asked.

"**Not just for you,**" Light Hope said. "**The others that came before you.**"

"There were other She-Ras?" Adora exclaimed.

"**Yes, there is so much more I can tell you once you are inside,**" Light Hope said.

"Fine, whatever," Adora groaned. She reached a large triangular door. There were many intricate symbols inscribed all over it, one of which she somehow recognized. "Eternia," she whispered.

The door suddenly fell through the ground, revealing a long, triangular hallway. "That's ominous."

Adora walked down the hallway, her footsteps echoing harshly off the crystalline walls. It led her to a hexagonal room, each wall having an identical hallway to the one she had just walked out of. In the center of the room was a low, hexagonal platform with a small set of stairs on each side. She walked onto the platform and a purple, see-through woman suddenly appeared. "**Administrator detected,**" she said. "**Hello, She-Ra, what is your query?**"

"Uh, hello?" Adora said.

"**Query not recognized,**" the woman said harshly.

"Uh, okay," Adora said, slightly annoyed. "Are you Light Hope?"

"**Light Hope,**" the woman said. There was a slight hint of a question in her voice.

"Yes," Adora said exasperatedly. "Where is she?"

"**Yes, Light Hope is here,**" the woman said. "**She has been waiting for you.**"

"Seems more like she was dragging me here," Adora said.

"**Query not recognized.**"

"Oh my gods," Adora groaned. "Is Light Hope going to talk to me or not?"

"**Light Hope will see you now.**" The woman suddenly vanished. All the light in the room disappeared.

"Huh? What's going on?" Adora tried to look at her hands but couldn't. "Light Hope?"

"**Hello, Adora.**" Light Hope appeared in front of her. She glowed a soft purple, slightly illuminating the area.

"Ah!" Adora held up her hands. Even the dim light that Light Hope was giving off was blinding to her in the darkness.

"**I've been waiting for you a long time, Adora,**" Light Hope said.

"It's been what, like four days?" Adora asked, lowering her arms. She squinted her eyes slightly as she got used to the light.

"**I have been waiting for the next She-Ra for over a thousand years,**" Light Hope said.

"A thousand years?" Adora gasped.

"**Yes,**" Light Hope affirmed. "**I was afraid that the power had been lost.**"

"Until I showed up," Adora said.

"**Yes,**" Light Hope said.

"Is that why I could read the weird writing on the door?" Adora asked. "Because I'm She-Ra?"

"**You are not ready for that answer yet,**" Light Hope said.

"Seriously?" Adora groaned.

"**Why would I not be serious?**" Light Hope asked.

"Never mind," Adora said. "What did you want to tell me?"

"**I want to show you what the mission of She-Ra is.**" Light Hope raised her hand. Light flooded back into the room.

Adora squinted her eyes. It was hard to tell, but this room was definitely different from the one before the light went out. *How did I get here without realizing it?*

"**The mission of She-Ra is to bring balance to the planet,**" Light Hope explained.

“Balance the planet?” Adora said. “Is that why the princesses thought that I was destined to save them?”

“**Yes,**” Light Hope said. “**A misinterpretation of your original mission. The Planet has been out of balance for a thousand years.**”
“When the last She-Ra was here?” Adora asked.

“**Yes,**” Light Hope said. “**The last She-Ra had a malfunction in her central processing unit and destroyed the balance.**”

“You mean her brain?” Adora asked. “She went crazy?”

“**Yes, she went… crazy,**” Light Hope said.

“So how do I balance the planet?” Adora asked.

“**It is a process that will take many years,**” Light Hope said. “**The last She-Ra, Mara, did quite a bit of damage, and it has only gotten worse with time.**”

“So, what?” Adora asked. “What do I do first?”

“**The war between the Horde and the princesses is destroying Etheria’s ecosystem,**” Light Hope said. “**The Horde must be defeated in order to maintain balance.**”

“What?” Adora shouted. “I’m not going to betray the Horde!”

“**The princesses are an essential part of of the planet’s balance,**” Light Hope said. “**Their connection to their rune stones create a balance of power.**”

“What about Scorpia?” Adora asked. “She doesn’t have a connection to the Black Garnet.”

“**Precisely,**” Light Hope said. “**The Horde captured the Black Garnet from Scorpia’s grandfather. Adora, they are bringing the planet out of balance.**”

“What does balancing the planet even mean?” Adora asked. “Why do the princesses have to control the planet?”

“**Adora, the planet needs to be balanced,**” Light Hope said. “**I cannot explain why. All will be revealed when the planet is balanced.**”

“If you can’t explain, then why should I believe you?” Adora asked.

“**You don’t need to believe me,**” Light Hope said. “**You just need to do as I say.**”

“I’m not going to blindly follow orders if you can’t offer more than vague gestures,” Adora said.

“**But you do that with the Horde?**” Light Hope asked.

“That’s different!” Adora shouted.

“**How?**” Light Hope asked. “**You have never once questioned the orders of the one you call ‘Shadow Weaver’.**”

“How could you possibly know something like that?” Adora asked.

“**I’ve been watching you for a long time, Adora,**” Light Hope said. “**I knew you were the next She-Ra but I could not reach you until you found the sword.**”

“That’s creepy,” Adora said. “Wait, even when Catra and I…”

“**Yes,**” Light Hope said. “**It was not pleasant for me.**”

“Could you maybe not?” Adora asked.

“**Unfortunately, I cannot,**” Light Hope said. “**I have been programmed to keep tabs on the current She-Ra at all times.**”

“That’s extremely creepy!” Adora shouted.

"**I have been described as 'creepy' before,**" Light Hope said. "**Especially by Mara. You do not want to be like Mara, Adora.**"

"Why not?" Adora shouted. "You've given some pretty good reasons why she might have had the right idea!"

"**Adora, this line of thinking is not tolerated,**" Light Hope warned. "**You must follow my orders without question.**"

"At least Shadow Weaver explained why I needed to do things!" Adora shouted.

"**Shadow Weaver is manipulating you,**" Light Hope said.

"I know that!" Adora shouted. "Everyone's been lying to me my whole life, and you're no exception!"
"**Adora!**"

"What?" Adora shouted. "Do you have anything real to say or can I go?"

"**Princess Scorpia,**" Light Hope said. "**She needs to forge her connection to the Black Garnet.**"

"What happens if she does?" Adora asked.

"**You will have completed one step of balancing the planet,**" Light Hope said. "**Nothing more.**"
"Why should I?" Adora asked.

"**For her sake, if you can't do it for mine,**" Light Hope said. "**She was supposed to inherit this power, and Shadow Weaver has prevented that. She *deserves* her birthright.**"

"Fine," Adora said. "I'm not sure what I can do though. Shadow Weaver will kill me if I try to take her power."

"**You are stronger than Shadow Weaver, Adora,**" Light Hope said. "**There is no one on Etheria who has the power to**

defeat you."

"If you say so," Adora said. *I wonder if she's including herself.* "Can I go now?"

"**If you insist,**" Light Hope said. "**But I urge you to stay and train.**"

"I've been away from home for too long," Adora said. "I have people who I don't have to coerce into staying."

"**Very well.**" Light Hope closed her eyes and disappeared. The entire room disappeared and the same darkness from earlier swallowed Adora. As quickly as it had left, the light returned and she was back to standing in the hexagonal room on the same platform. The doors to all the hallways were shut.

"Ah!" Adora shouted.

"**Greetings, administrator,**" the purple woman from earlier appeared again. Now Adora could notice the distinction between her and Light Hope. This lady was more curved and wore a different outfit. "**What is your query?**"

"Which one is the way out?" Adora asked.

"**Query not recognized.**"

Adora sighed. "Which hallway leads out of here?"

"**Query not recognized.**"

"Where is the exit to this building?" Adora shouted.

"**The exit to the Crystal Castle is this hallway,**" the woman said. The door behind Adora slid open.

"Thanks," Adora said.

"**Query not recognized.**"

“Oh my gods,” Adora groaned.

“Words cannot describe my disappointment with you, Catra,” Shadow Weaver spat. She paced in front of her, her tendrils, both on her head and robe, twisting and flipping wildly around her. “This was supposed to be a simple mission, one where Adora could keep an eye on you while completing this simple task. But no! Not only did you let the princesses completely restore the Sea Gate, you also let Adora get captured! She’s in Brightmoon now! We can’t send a rescue party out there!”

“I wasn’t even in charge of this mission!” Catra said. “I’m just a *cadet.* You put Adora and Scorpia in charge of this mission. Adora let herself get captured!”

“Do not talk back to me, Catra,” Shadow Weaver said. Her shadows expanded across the walls of Adora’s room, completely surrounding them both. “Your insolence is something I’ve tolerated for far too long. You’ve only made it this long because *Adora* was fond of you, but no more! Adora has been lost forever, they could have even turned her against is by now, and therefore you no longer have a *use* here.”

“What are you saying?” Catra asked weakly.

“You are going to *Beast Island!*” Shadow Weaver hissed. “I never want to see your wretched face again!”

Shadow Weaver’s tendrils wrapped around Catra, completely immobilizing her. She struggled but to know avail. Shadow Weaver carried her away and threw her into a cell, using her tendrils to cuff Catra’s wrists. The green light screen appeared between them.

“You’re going on the next shipment out of here,” Shadow Weaver said. “You had better hope that Adora somehow comes back before then.”

“You monster!” Catra shrieked, falling to her knees. She hadn’t let herself cry at all since the mission failure, but she couldn’t hold it in any longer. She wept, loudly. A flood of tears fell from her face to the cold steel floor of her cell. “Why are you doing this to me?”

“I’ve hated you for as long as I’ve known you, Catra,” Shadow Weaver spat. “Now I finally have the opportunity to get rid of you.” She promptly turned and left, leaving Catra alone.

Adora found her way out of the Whispering Woods surprisingly quickly. It had seemed to guide her out, as if the woods themselves wanted her to leave. *Maybe Light Hope did,* she thought.

It was only a few kilometers hike to the edge of the Fright Zone. It was nice, flat terrain, basically a pleasant stroll. Adora was excited. She couldn’t wait to see Catra, to hold her, to kiss her. She never wanted to leave Catra’s side again.

“Force Captain Adora?” One of the soldiers standing at the edge of the Fright Zone asked. “I- I thought you were a prisoner at Brightmoon.”

“At ease, soldier,” Adora said, talking past the pair. “I broke out. It wasn’t that hard.”

She ran through this far more familiar labyrinth of buildings and hallways toward her room, feeling more and more like she was at home with every corner she turned. Catra was waiting for her and Adora couldn’t wait to shower her with a million kisses. She reached her door and stepped inside.

“Catra! I-” Adora froze. Catra was not in her room, only other soldiers. They were packing up her things into boxes. “What’s going on?”

“Uh, Force Captain!” one of the soldiers dropped a box full of Adora’s clothes. “Shadow Weaver told us to clean out the room. She said that you weren’t coming back.”

“Well, I am back!” Adora shouted. “So put all my stuff back!”

“Yes, Force Captain,” the soldier said. They picked up the box and started unloading it back into Adora’s locker. The other soldiers followed suit and reversed course.

“Where’s Catra?” Adora demanded.

“No idea.” One of the soldier shrugged. “Nobody’s seen her in a while. Shadow Weaver seemed really mad at her after she came back from that mission.”

“Oh, no.” Adora turned and ran for the Black Garnet chamber. *She didn’t get sent to Beast Island, did she?* she thought. *Surely Shadow Weaver wouldn’t be* that *cruel.* She reached the chamber and banged her fist on the door. “Shadow Weaver!”

The door opened. Shadow Weaver stood before Adora. “Ah, Adora!” she said cheerfully. “What a pleasant surprise. I didn’t expect that you would escape from Brightmoon… so soon.”

“Cut the shit!” Adora shouted. She forcefully grabbed Shadow Weaver’s collar. “Where’s Catra?”

“Adora, this is highly inappropriate,” Shadow Weaver said. “Let go of me, now!”

“Not until you tell me where Catra is!” Adora demanded.

“I said let *go!*” Shadow raised her hands and an invisible force pushed Adora back.

Adora drew her sword. “Where is she?”

“She’s being sent off to Beast Island,” Shadow Weaver said. “She’s lucky that the transport’s been delayed or it would have left already.”

“*Beast Island?*” Adora shouted. “How could you?”

“I had to,” Shadow Weaver hissed. “She was a *failure.* She let the princesses restore the Sea Gate. She let *you* get captured. Don’t you want to see her gone?”

“Even if that all was her fault,” Adora said. “I would never want her shipped off to *Beast Island!*”

“She only holds you back, Adora,” Shadow Weaver said. “You could become so much stronger if you just let go of her!”

“Then I guess I’ll be weak forever,” Adora said. “Where is she?”

“If you are going to be so selfish as to try to rescue her, you will not-”

“Enough!” Adora shouted. “You’ve always hated her, always wanted her gone. You only kept her around because I liked her, didn’t you? I bet you reveled in the chance to get rid of her as soon as you thought I wasn’t coming back.”

“So what if I did?” Shadow Weaver spat. “She will never amount to anything. She was a waste of time and resources.”

“You’re a monster,” Adora said. “Tell me where she is, or I’ll have no choice but to fight you.”

“Adora, you have no idea what you’re doing.” Magical energy began to swirl around Shadow Weaver’s hands.

“Unfortunately, I do,” Adora said grimly. She held her sword high above her head. “*For the honor of Grayskull!*”

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

Haha, Beast Island! We love going to Beast Island, don't we? Anyway, Adora is about to test Light Hope's theory that she can defeat Shadow Weaver and it's going to be a *interesting.* New chapter coming soon!

Comments are always appreciated!

Save the Cat

Chapter Summary

Adora and Shadow Weaver fight. Catra is not okay.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora transformed into her She-Ra form in a flash of light.

"If you think that you can defeat me, then you're more naive than I thought," Shadow Weaver taunted. "I have more power than you could possibly imagine."

"Just tell me where Catra is," Adora said. "If you send her to Beast Island, I'll just go and rescue her anyway."

"You'll just get yourself killed," Shadow Weaver said. "Let her go, Adora. She's a lost cause."

"*You're* the lost cause," Adora spat.

"Don't make me kill you," Shadow Weaver said.

"You won't kill me," Adora said. "You need my power."

"That doesn't mean I won't make you forget your precious *Catra,*" Shadow Weaver said. "I can completely wipe your mind and make you start over. There won't be a hint of disobedience left when I'm done with you."

"You make me sick." Adora charged Shadow Weaver. Shadow Weaver raised her hand and great tendrils shot up from under her robe, binding Adora's wrists and ankles.

Adora laughed. "I've already seen this trick today." She thrashed her arms and legs, loosening the restraints.

Shadow Weaver clenched her fists. The tendrils tightened themselves again. Adora swiped her sword at the ground, severing the tendrils that were latched onto her ankles. They writhed at her feet, as if they were dying animals, then faded back into nothing. Adora swung her arms, stretching and tearing the tendrils that fell to the ground and disappeared. Shadow Weaver waved her arms and sent dark purple blasts at Adora. She stepped forward and swung her sword, slicing the blasts into nothing.

"Is that all you've got?" Adora taunted.
"Not nearly." Shadow Weaver disappeared into the floor in a dark vortex.

Adora looked around the hall. There was no sign of Shadow Weaver's magic anywhere. Suddenly, she felt a sharp pain in her back and she was thrust forward. She quickly turned around, only catching a glimpse of Shadow Weaver before she disappeared again.

Adora felt sweat begin to drip down her forehead. She looked around the room again, hoping to see where Shadow Weaver would reappear. She heard a slight whisper on her left and turned only to be blasted again. She staggered back, clutching the spot on her chest where she had been hit.

"Give up now, Adora," Shadow Weaver said.

"Never!" Adora charged Shadow Weaver. She swung her sword down, only for her to disappear again. "Could you stop doing that?"

Shadow Weaver's cold laugh echoed throughout the hallway. It was like her voice was coming from right inside Adora's ear.

Adora heard the beginnings of the same whisper and swung her arm to it. She struck Shadow Weaver in the chest, sending her staggering back to the entrance of the Black Garnet chamber.

“Enough!” Shadow Weaver thrust her fists forward. Dark, magical, energy surrounded her entire body before she blasted it toward Adora.

Adora held her sword in front of her to block. It glowed bright and turned itself into a great, golden shield. Shadow Weaver’s blast struck the shield, causing Adora to stagger back. She dug her heels into the metal-plated floor as best she could and pushed back against it.

“Face it, Adora,” Shadow Weaver said. Her voice echoed throughout the hall. “You cannot hope to stand against my power. I trained for years with the greatest sorcerers in the world, and now I’m the only one to have made a connection with a rune stone. You are outmatched!”

“You’re wrong!” Adora took a heavy step forward. “I’m stronger than you think!” She took another step. “You didn’t think I could escape Brightmoon on my own, but I did!” Another step. “You’ve always wanted to control me, to control my power.” Two more steps. “But I’ve had enough!” She swung the shield. The blast reflected back at Shadow Weaver, knocking her back to the Black Garnet.

“How…?” Shadow Weaver gasped.

“You look just as shocked as the Queen of Brightmoon,” Adora said. “I had to take on half a dozen princesses to get out of there, and you thought that I couldn’t best one old hag?”

Shadow Weaver glared at her. “You’re becoming arrogant, Adora,” she spat. “It’s not like you. You’re letting Catra distract you from-”

“You don’t get to talk about her like that!” Adora shouted. “Tell me where she is, or I’ll… I’ll…”

“You’ll do what, Adora? Kill me?” Shadow Weaver asked. “You’ll mark yourself as a traitor to the Horde, and Lord Hordak will sic his forces on you and Catra. Do you think she’ll survive that?”

"You'll be too dead to find out!" Adora shouted. "Do you really want Catra to die so much that you're willing to die yourself to make it happen?"

"You're making a mistake," Shadow Weaver hissed. "I'm doing this for *you.* Catra is making you *weak.* She *needs* to be out of your way."

"She *needs* my help!" Adora walked toward Shadow Weaver. The shield turned back into a sword and she pointed it at her. "Where is she?"

"If you think I'll tell-" Shadow Weaver started.

"Now!" Adora touched the tip of the sword to Shadow Weaver's chest, piecing her robe. "Or I'll push this sword right through you!"

"Adora…"

Adora put pressure on the sword. "*Don't make me kill you.*"

"She's on cell block four, floor twenty-five, cell two," Shadow Weaver said. "You *will* regret this."

"Then make me," Adora said. She pulled the sword back and walked away.

Catra sat facing away from the light screen. She didn't want to look outside, didn't want to tempt herself with the possibility of seeing Adora walking up and saving her. There was no hope of rescue. The only thing that would take her out of the cell was Shadow Weaver about to ship her off to Beast Island, and she didn't particularly care about seeing her. Her face was soaked with tears. She had cried for hours, and the only reason she stopped

was because she didn't seem to have any tears left. Even her body had given up.

Catra heard multiple voices shouting. Her ears twitched. She couldn't make out the words but it sounded like someone was trying to start a fight. She almost turned her head to try to get a glimpse of what was going on. She didn't; it's not like she could've gotten a good look anyway with her cell being so far down. The commotion stopped and her ears went still. It was nothing to worry about after all, probably just some guard that lost a big gamble or something.

Catra's ears twitched again. There were footsteps, footsteps that were getting louder. Shadow Weaver didn't walk, she floated. This was someone else, probably a guard. But it wasn't meal time yet. This was for something else. Catra's interest had been piqued, and she turned her head. Whoever it was would pass her cell soon. The footsteps grew louder and louder until…

"Adora?"

"Hey, Catra," Adora said softly.

"No, you're just some trick by Shadow Weaver," Catra said. "You can't fool me!"

"Catra, no!" Adora quickly ran over to the control panel and disabled the light screen. "It's me, I promise!"

"You're gone!" Catra shouted. "They took you! They took you away and you didn't come back!"

"Catra, please, it's me!" Adora rushed over to Catra.

"Stay back!" Catra shouted. "I'm warning you-"

Adora embraced Catra, tightly. "I'm real! I got out!" she said. "I promise!"

“Let go of me!” Catra tried to wriggle out of Adora’s grasp, a task made difficult by the cuffs around her wrist.

“Catra, please,” Adora whispered. “I love you.”

Catra’s eyes went wide and she stopped trying to resist. It *was* her, she was back. She returned Adora’s embrace, clenching her tightly. “I love you too,” she whispered, her tears returning. She sobbed loudly, tears dripping heavily from her cheeks onto Adora’s jacket.

Adora stroked Catra’s hair. “I’m here,” she whispered. “I’m here.”

“Adora…” Catra sobbed.

“Sh-sh-sh,” Adora said. “You don’t have to say anything. I’ve got you, and I’m never leaving you behind again.”

“Promise?” Catra asked, sobs breaking up her voice.

“I promise,” Adora said firmly. She released the hug and stood up. “Now, let’s get out of here.

She detached a key ring from her belt and used one of the keys to release Catra’s cuffs from her wrists. Catra rubbed her wrists and hesitantly stood up. Adora put her hands on her shoulders and together they slowly walked out of the cell. Catra barely looked up for the entire journey to Adora’s room, only when she heard someone else near them. She was still terrified that, at any moment, Shadow Weaver would show up and take her away from Adora, but thankfully, that moment never came.

When they reached Adora’s room, Catra quickly leapt onto the bed and curled up, facing away from Adora. She wrapped her tail around one of her legs. She felt Adora sit down next to her. Adora’s hand began to caress Catra’s arm. She winced at Adora’s touch.

“Shit, I’m sorry!” Adora said, recoiling her hand.

“No, you’re fine.” Catra rolled over to face Adora. She noticed that she had taken off her boots and jacket. “It’s just…”

“You’re scared?” Adora asked. “I am too.”

“Don’t tell anyone that I am,” Catra growled.

“I won’t,” Adora promised. “Just… let me take care of you, okay?”

Catra nodded. Adora laid down next to her and wrapped an arm around her, pulling her in close.

“Adora, what are we going to do?” Catra asked.

“About what?”

“Shadow Weaver, she just tried to get rid of me,” Catra said. “And she’ll probably try to do it again.”

“I won’t let her do that,” Adora said. “I promise.”

Catra whimpered and leaned her head against Adora’s chest. Adora took her other arm and began to stroke Catra’s hair. Catra purred. She didn’t feel particularly safe, but Adora was protecting her.

“You’re purring,” Adora said cheerfully. “You haven’t done that in a while.”

“I might have done it around someone else,” Catra said. “You don’t know.”

“You don’t purr when others are around,” Adora said. “Only for me.”

“You caught me,” Catra chuckled. “I only do it for you.”

“My adorable little kitten, purring just for me,” Adora said softly.

Catra whimpered.

“Sorry, did you not like that?” Adora asked.

“No, I did.” Catra buried her face in Adora’s chest.

“Okay, *kitten,*” Adora said. She leaned her head down and kissed Catra’s forehead. “I’ll try to keep that in mind.”

A long time passed before either of them moved. They were both content to have each other; nothing else was needed.

Catra heard the door to the room begin to open. Quickly, she pushed Adora off the bed and sat up.

“Ah!” Adora shouted as she hit the floor. She looked up. “Huh?”

Shadow Weaver floated through the doorway.

“Get out!” Adora stood up. “Now!”

“Adora, please,” Shadow Weaver started.

“I don’t care!” Adora shouted. “Get out of my room, now!”

“I can’t do that,” Shadow Weaver sighed.

“Why not?” Adora asked. “Did you come to finish Catra off? Your mind games won’t work on me anymore, so don’t lie!”

“Adora, Lord Hordak has requested your presence,” Shadow Weaver said. “He was very interested to learn about what caused the commotion outside the Black Garnet chamber earlier.”

“Adora, what happened?” Catra asked.

“She refused to tell me where you were,” Adora said. “I had to find out.”

“She threatened my life,” Shadow Weaver said. “An unequivocal act of insubordination. Something she wouldn’t have done without *your* influence.”

“I said enough mind games!” Adora shouted. “You can’t control me like that anymore!”
“I am still your superior officer, Force Captain,” Shadow Weaver said. “I suggest you go now. You do *not* want to keep Lord Hordak waiting.”

“Fine,” Adora said. “Now, get out of my room!”

“Very well,” Shadow Weaver said. “But it won’t be yours for very long.” She turned and floated out of the room.

“Fuck,” Adora sighed. She walked over to Catra and put her hands on her shoulders. “Catra, everything’s going to be okay. I promise. I’ll work it out. I- I’ll fix this.”

“What if you don’t?” Catra asked.

“Lock the door when I leave,” Adora said. “If I don’t come back tonight, just…”
“Just what?” Catra said nervously.

“Just get as far away from Shadow Weaver as you can!” Adora said. “Leave the Fright Zone if you have to. I- I won’t let her hurt you again. I promise.”

“Adora…”

Adora grabbed Catra’s cheeks and kissed her. Catra could feel the desperation in it, as if it was the last time. She didn’t want it to be. The last four days with Adora had been something she never could have hoped for in her wildest dreams. But it was real. It was real and they might be about to lose each other forever. Catra wrapped her arms around Adora tightly. She didn’t want to let her go.

Adora pulled back. “I love you.”

“I love you too.”

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

The first, but not the last, fight between Adora and Shadow Weaver. Catra is going to be fine, I promise! (She won't. Sorry, but this is not of feel-good fic.) Being emotionally dependent on someone like that is not good and it is not going to end well, for either of them. Anyway, we're about to see what Hordak has to say about all of this and it is going to be *interesting.*

Comments are always appreciated!

The First Crack

Chapter Summary

Hordak and Adora talk. Adora sets a trap.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora walked down the winding hallways of the Fright Zone with a sinking feeling in her stomach. It had been incredibly difficult to leave Catra, but she unfortunately had to. If they had been taught anything in the Horde, it was to never disappoint Lord Hordak. She had brought her sword. It was more important now than ever that she didn't part from it.

Adora reached the door to Hordak's sanctum. The large double doors, while impressive in their own right, were not as awe-inspiring as the ones in Brightmoon had been. Two muscular guards stood on either side of the entrance, holding pikes tipped with stun batons.

Adora stepped forward. "Lord Hordak wanted to see me."

"Force Captain Adora," one of the guards said. "Leave your weapons at the door."

Adora pulled the knife out of her boot and handed it to the guard.

"*All* of your weapons," the guard said.

Adora sighed. She reached into her jacket and pulled out her bolo, flash-bang, smoke ball, multi-knife, and portable fork. "There."

"Force Captain, your sword," the guard said.

"This is She-Ra's sword," Adora said. "And I'm She-Ra. Understand?"

“I can’t allow you to take your sword with you,” the guard said.

“Do you really want to fight She-Ra for it?” Adora asked. “I defeated Shadow Weaver on my own, you know? That’s why I’m here.”

“Are you threatening us?” The guards raised their pikes in a defensive stance.

“Not necessarily,” Adora said. “I promise not to hurt him, okay?”

The guards didn’t let up their stance.

“What? Do you think you can defeat me?” Adora said.

The guards looked at each other and then stood upright again. “Enter.”

“Thank you,” Adora said. The doors slid open and she walked through.

The room was dimly lit. Great, mechanical pillars held up the impossibly high ceiling. A maze of tubes and containers filled with dangerous-looking liquids expanded into the inky blackness on either side of the central walkway. At the far end of the room there was a long staircase leading up to a massive throne; a throne that was empty.

“You’ve been very bold since your promotion, Force Captain.”

Adora turned around. Lord Hordak had snuck up behind her and was staring down at her with blood red eyes. “You even brought the weapon of She-Ra into my presence,” he continued.

“Can you blame me?” Adora asked.

“No, I did not expect you to part with it,” Hordak growled. “That is part of my… *concern,* Force Captain. You openly attacked Shadow Weaver, threatening to kill her. I can’t have this kind of open insubordination in my empire.”

“She was going to send Catra to Beast Island, I had to do something!” Adora pleaded.

“Ah, yes, *Catra.*” Hordak walked in a half circle around Adora toward his throne. “Don’t think I don’t know what’s been going on between you and your… *‘girlfriend’.*”

The sound of Adora and Catra’s breathless moans echoed throughout the room. Adora felt a sudden pang of fear run throughout her entire body. She took a few nervous steps back.

“How…?” she began to ask.

The sound stopped and a small, blue, winged, humanoid flew down from the rafters and sat on Hordak’s shoulder, its pointed tail draped down his chest. “Girlfriend,” it said in Adora’s voice.

“My little spy has been hard at work,” Hordak said. “I make it my mission to know everything going on in the Fright Zone. Don’t think you can escape my reach.”

“Lord Hordak, I…” Adora said.

“You what?” Hordak demanded. He began to walk slowly toward Adora. “You ignored protocol and engaged in *reproductive activities* with a subordinate? You disobeyed direct orders and attempted to kill your superior officer? What excuses do you have for your actions, Force Captain? Why should I not send you on the next shipment to Beast Island?”

“You’d really get rid of *She-Ra?*” Adora asked. “You ship me off and I’ll take my power to the enemy.”

“So you think that gives you the right to break whatever rules you want?” Hordak asked. “My empire is a machine made of loyal soldiers. Do not be the first crack in the machine.”

“I won’t, if Shadow Weaver minds her own business,” Adora said.

“Shadow Weaver is your superior officer,” Hordak said. “I think she has a right to know about you *breaching protocol* with your subordinate.”

“Did you… tell her?” Adora asked nervously.

Hordak let out a cold, humorless laugh. “Not yet,” he chuckled. “But give me a good reason and you can say goodbye to your Catra.”

“What does that mean?” Adora asked.

“It means that this little summer romance ends,” Hordak says. “Catra has proven to be a distraction in the past for you, and this new relationship hasn’t seemed to help much.”
“According to Shadow Weaver,” Adora said.

“According to your *actions,* Force Captain,” Hordak said. “Or perhaps there is another reason that you’ve been behaving so poorly?”

“Maybe She-Ra has something to do with it,” Adora said.

“Ah, yes, She-Ra,” Hordak said. “The prin*cess* of power. How could I forget? So you’re saying that your new power has made you arrogant, then?”

“Well, no…” Adora said. “That’s not what I meant.”

“Oh, but I think it is,” Hordak said. “You think your newfound power makes you untouchable. How long do you think it will be before you’re proven wrong? You were kidnapped at Salineas.”

“But I escaped, didn’t I?” Adora said. “I had to fight four princesses at once.”

“And yet it only took two princesses to take you out,” Hordak said. “You’re strong, but vulnerable. A cannon made of glass. Fire it wrong and, well, I’m sure you get the picture.”

“So what?” Adora said. “I’m just supposed to roll over and let Shadow Weaver do whatever she wants to Catra?”

“You care too much for her,” Hordak said. “Catra is Shadow Weaver’s responsibility. She will handle her how she sees fit, and what she does is none of your concern!”

“Does it concern you that she tried to ship her off to Beast Island after I got captured?” Adora asked. “Or do you think she’s infallible?”

“I’m sure she had a good reason,” Hordak said. “One she doesn’t have to tell you.”

“She told Catra,” Adora said. “Do you want to guess what it was?”

“I don’t particularly care,” Hordak said. “Dealing with cadets is not my responsibility.”

“She said that she’d been looking for an excuse to get rid of her!” Adora shouted. “She said now that I wasn’t coming back she had no reason to keep her around. She locked her in the detention block!”

“Why keep her around this long, then?” Hordak said. “It doesn’t add up.”

“Because of me,” Adora said. “She thought I’d be easier to control if she kept her around.”

“Because you’re *in love* with her,” Hordak said.

Adora blushed, then nodded.

“You were never the rebellious type before this,” Hordak said. “Why would she need her to keep you docile?”

“She keeps saying that she’s always sensed ‘great power’ in me, whatever that means,” Adora said. “She denied knowing that I was She-Ra, but I’m not sure if I believe her.”

“She never informed me of this ‘great power’,” Hordak said. “Not until *after* you appeared as She-Ra.”

“So she was keeping it from you,” Adora said. “Only spilling it when she had to.”

“Or maybe she wasn’t sure,” Hordak said. “Maybe she was lying to encourage you. There are a myriad of reasons.”

“Then why keep Catra around?” Adora asked. “It doesn’t make sense. She’s always been cruel and violent with her. There’s nothing special about me if I’m not She-Ra.”

“You’ve consistently been the top-performing member of your squad,” Hordak said. “The best of your age. You’ve been a prodigy since you were young.”

“What did she tell you about our fight?” Adora asked.

“I don’t have to tell you that,” Hordak growled. “Shadow Weaver said it to me in confidence. I won’t betray her like that so easily, especially not for you.”

“And she wouldn’t?” Adora asked. “She used to work for the princesses, used to be some sort of teacher. I learned that in Brightmoon, not from here.”

“So what?” Hordak asked. “I already knew where she came from.”
“She betrayed the people she dedicated her life to,” Adora said. “Who’s to say she won’t do the same for you?”

“Like you haven’t?” Hordak asked. “We’ve already discussed how you’re willing to threaten your superior’s life to save your precious *Catra,* an act of indisputable insubordination. Am I supposed to believe your loyalties lie entirely with me and my empire?”

“I’ve been with the Horde my whole life,” Adora said. “I worked my ass off to get out of Brightmoon, and where did I go to after that? Here. I could have gone somewhere else, even joined the

princesses, but I didn't. Do you think Shadow Weaver would have done the same?"

Hordak just glared at her.

"I won't apologize for trying to save the person I love," Adora said. "But I think I've proven my loyalty."

"I wasn't asking for an apology," Hordak said.

"So what are you asking for?" Adora asked.

"I'm asking for your loyalty, Force Captain," Hordak said harshly. "Your power is the ultimate weapon that will decide the outcome of this war. I would much prefer it to be used in service of my empire."

"You have my loyalty," Adora said. "She-Ra's power will serve the Horde, and *only* the Horde."

"Excellent," Hordak said. He turned and walked toward his throne.

"I just want one thing," Adora said.

"Do you really think you're in a position to make demands, Force Captain?" Hordak stopped walking and turned his head. "You're on very thin ice as it is."

"I'd like to keep my relationship with Catra," Adora said.

"Why would I allow that?"

"To see where Shadow Weaver's loyalties lie," Adora said.

"What are you talking about?" Hordak turned around.

"Setting a trap for her," Adora said. "Put Catra in my care. If Shadow Weaver is loyal to the Horde, loyal to you, she shouldn't have any problem with it, right?"

"And if she isn't?" Hordak asked.

“Once she finds out that we’re together, she would try to take Catra out,” Adora said. “I don’t imagine that *that* would be in the Horde’s interest, would it?”

“Hm,” Hordak said. “You’re willing to make your *girlfriend* the bait for a trap? You would risk her life like that?”

“I will never let Shadow Weaver hurt her,” Adora said, determined.

“Shadow Weaver will protest this arrangement,” Hordak said.

“For what reason?” Adora asked. “What reason would she have to keep Catra in her care if she clearly hates her?”

“Hm,” Hordak said. “You truly believe that she’s disloyal, don’t you?”

Adora nodded.

“If you’re wrong, you can kiss your Catra goodbye,” Hordak said.

“And if I’m right?” Adora asked.

“Then you *may* keep courting her,” Hordak said, turning around. “So long as it doesn’t cause any cracks in my machine.”

“So, how did it go?” Catra asked as soon as Adora entered the room. She was sitting cross-legged on the bed, staring at the door.

“Better than I expected.” Adora leaned her sword up against the wall and took off her boots. She sat down on the bed next to Catra. “I think we’re going to be okay.”

“You think?” Catra asked.

Adora pulled Catra in for a kiss. “If this works, we’ll be rid of Shadow Weaver for good,” she said. “She won’t be able to hurt us.”

“And if it doesn’t?”

“It *will,*” Adora said. “I promise.”

‘Okay…” Catra looked down.

“Hey.” Adora lifted Catra’s chin up. “I’m not going to let her hurt you again. I’m going to protect you, no matter what it takes.”

“You promise?”
“I promise.” Adora leaned in and kissed Catra. It felt so good to be back home, to be back with Catra. As far as she was concerned, this life they had together was nothing short of a miracle and she wasn’t going to let it be taken away from her. Not for anything.

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

Everything is fine! Don't worry about it! Nothing bad could possibly happen anytime soon, why would you even ask that? Finale of part one is next time, and part two will start when I finish it.

Comments are always appreciated!

Dissent

Chapter Summary

Shadow Weaver hurts Catra. Adora steps in.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora woke up with Catra in her arms. Her fur was soft, as soft as she'd ever felt it. Adora stroked her hand through her soft mane, scratching a little behind her ears. Catra purred and leaned her head against Adora's chest. She winced slightly, but the pain was minimal and she didn't mind sticking it out for Catra.

"Hey, kitten," Adora said softly.

"Hey, Adora," Catra purred.

"I think this is the happiest I've seen you," Adora said.

"Hm, wonder why," Catra said.

"Hm." Adora ran her hand through Catra's hair again. "I guess it can't be explained then."

Catra chuckled and put her hand on Adora's waist. "I love you."

"I love you too," Adora said. She wanted to stay like this all day, maybe forever, just holding each other in bed. But she knew that it couldn't last, not for long anyway. If she was right, her next confrontation with Shadow Weaver was inevitable, and very soon at that. She needed to be at full strength in order to protect Catra. "Okay, I think we have to get up now."

"Whyyyyyyy?" Catra groaned, her voice muffled by Adora's chest. "Can't we just stay like this forever?"

“Unfortunately no,” Adora said. She tried to sit up but Catra’s hand on her waist stopped her. “Catra, can you…?”

“Fine.” Catra pulled her hand back.

“Thanks.” Adora sat up and hopped out of bed. She sighed. She dreaded what was coming next, but she couldn’t avoid it. She stood up and turned to face Catra. Catra looked sad, looking down at the bed with her arm outstretched to where Adora was just laying. “Look, I’m sorry, but I can’t stay with you all day, okay?”

“It’s fine,” Catra mumbled.

“Is it?” Adora leaned down and put a hand on Catra’s shoulder. “It doesn’t seem fine.”
“I said I’m fine!” Catra swiped Adora’s hand away.

“Catra, I’m just trying to help,” Adora said, recoiling her hand. “I care about you a lot. Please let me help you.”

“Why do you have to go?” Catra asked, sorrow in her voice. “Why do you have to leave me again?”

“I’m not trying to leave you,” Adora said. “I promised that I wouldn’t leave you again and I intend to keep that promise. I’m doing this to protect you, to protect us. I won’t be gone long.”

“But what if she- what if she comes back?” Catra asked.

“She won’t,” Adora said firmly. “I won’t let it happen.”

“But she always does,” Catra said.

“After today, she won’t be able to,” Adora said. “Lord Hordak is going to make sure of that.”

“What?” Catra looked up.

“I’ll explain everything later,” Adora said. “It’s going to be okay, I promise.”

“Okay.” Catra shifted her legs off the bed and stood up.

Adora grabbed Catra’s hands in hers and kissed her knuckles. “I love you.”

“I love you too.” Catra leaned in and planted a kiss on Adora’s cheek.

Suddenly, the door to the room opened and Shadow Weaver floated in. Catra turned her head, shock and fear apparent in her eyes.

“I see what’s going on now,” Shadow Weaver hissed. Dark swirls of magic ignited around her hands and she reached out toward Catra. Catra’s body completely tensed up as it was surrounded by a haze of red energy. “I was baffled when Lord Hordak informed me that you were being placed under *Adora’s* care. She doesn’t have the proper position or training to be a ward for a *worthless* cadet like you. But you tricked her into falling in love you to protect yourself, didn’t you?” Adora grabbed her sword and made a heavy swing at Shadow Weaver. She raised her free hand and froze Adora’s sword with the same red energy. “Adora, I expected better of you. I trained you not to fall for these *manipulations.*”

“You trained me to fall for *yours,*” Adora said. “I’m done with that.”

“How disappointing,” Shadow Weaver growled. “I had such high hopes for you, Force Captain.”

“You had high hopes for *yourself,*” Adora said. “You wanted to use me as a weapon, a mindless drone for you to puppet around to satisfy your lust for power. You never saw me or Catra as people, just tools for you to get what you wanted. Well, news flash! Catra and I are people, people who have outgrown the need for you!” Adora could feel her magic swelling inside her as she shouted. With all her strength, she broke free of Shadow Weaver’s magical hold and held her sword high above her head. “*For the honor of Grayskull!*”

Adora transformed in a flash of light. Before, she was shorter than Shadow Weaver, but now it felt like she was towering over her in the small space. She swung her sword down between Shadow Weaver and Catra, causing Shadow Weaver's concentration to break and the red energy holding Catra to dissipate.

"You've gotten away with attacking me once, Force Captain," Shadow Weaver said. "Do you think you can get away with it again?"

"Sure, when you lose again," Adora said. She swung her sword again, forcing Shadow Weaver to retreat out of the room. She turned to Catra. "Are you okay?"

"No," Catra groaned. She was laying face down on the floor.

"Stay here," Adora said. "It's going to be okay. I promise." She ran out of the room, swinging her sword.

Shadow Weaver dodged the attacks and slipped behind Adora. She threw small magic blasts toward her but Adora turned around and transformed her sword into a shield to block them. Shadow Weaver raised her hand and a group of black tendrils sprung out of nowhere, quickly latching themselves onto Adora's limbs.

"I thought we already tried this," Adora said.

"Not *this.*" Shadow Weaver clenched her fist and the tendrils send powerful jolts of electricity through Adora's body.

"Argh!" Adora's feet gave out, but she didn't fall as the tendrils on her arms held her body up. She struggled against the tendrils, but at least three were attached to each of her limbs, and their combined strength was too strong. She turned her shield back into a sword, trying to cut them away, but she couldn't get an angle with how restricted her wrists were.

"You were *lucky* last time, Force Captain," Shadow Weaver said, stalking toward Adora. "I underestimated your ability, but I will not *hold back* again."

Adora strained her body to get herself back on her feet. The tendrils pulled down on her legs and forced her down to her knees with her arms lifted up behind her back. She dropped the sword, transforming back into her regular self. The height difference caused her to fall down a slight bit, with her arms being forced back further, painfully stretching her shoulders.

"You were foolish to go against me like that again," Shadow Weaver said. She knelt down in front of Adora and put a hand to her cheek. "You should have quit while you were ahead and maintained your favor with me. Now, you and your precious Catra will die for nothing."

"Like hell you will!"

Shadow Weaver stood up and turned around. Catra leapt from the doorway, landing a forceful punch to the face, knocking her over. The tendrils holding Adora retreated back into nothing, releasing her.

Catra landed gracefully and picked up Adora's sword. "You okay?" she asked, extending her hand to Adora.

"Yeah," Adora lied. She grabbed Catra's hand and stood up. "I told you to stay in the room."

Catra handed Adora's sword back to her. "You're welcome."

"You insolent *rats!*" Shadow Weaver hissed, standing up. "How *dare* you turn against me like this?"

"It's been a long time coming, Shadow Weaver," Catra said. "Adora's not your puppet anymore. You can't turn us against each other like you used to. We're *done* with your shit."

"Then you will perish!" Shadow Weaver sent a magic blast at Catra. Adora stepped in and blocked it with her sword.

"No thanks!" Catra jumped up on Adora's back and leapt off her shoulders toward Shadow Weaver. She swiped her claws at her

mask, creating a large crack down its center and shattering the gem in its forehead.

"*No!*" Shadow Weaver shouted, falling to her knees. "You can't do this to me! I worked so hard for this, for everything! How dare you treat the woman who raised you this way? I've done everything for you!"

"You've done everything for yourself," Catra said.

"No, no!" Shadow Weaver grabbed her comm pad out of her robe and called Hordak.

"What?" Hordak demanded.

"Force Captain Adora attacked me!" Shadow Weaver said frantically. "Quickly, you have to do something!"
"She beat you, didn't she?" Hordak asked.

"*We* beat her," Catra said.

"It appears that they did," Hordak said. "And it appears that you've lost your connection to the Black Garnet as well."

"My lord, what should I do?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Just wait patiently," Hordak said. "Some guards will come escort you to your holding cell shortly."

"My lord!" Shadow Weaver shouted. "How could you do this to me?"

"This was a test for you to prove your loyalty to me," Hordak said. "And you *failed.* You have been nothing but deceitful and petty since you came here, and I suspect you were the same during your time at Mysticor. I don't need someone like you in our ranks, but I do need someone like Force Captain Adora. She has proven herself to be *truly* loyal."

"You're betraying me?" Shadow Weaver asked.

“No,” Hordak said. “You betrayed *me* the moment you decided that to kill our most powerful asset.”

“But, but…” Shadow Weaver’s voice trailed off.

“Goodbye, traitor,” Hordak said. “Your services will not be missed.” The screen of the comm pad went black.

“Lord Hordak!” Shadow Weaver screamed.

“C’mon,” Catra said to Adora. “This is just sad. Let’s go.”

“Alright.” Adora followed Catra back to her room.

“What was that about?” Catra asked, flopping down on the bed.

“Oh, that?” Adora said. “That was the outcome of my meeting with Hordak.”

“You got him to side with us?” Catra said. “How did you pull *that* off?”

“I got him to believe that Shadow Weaver would betray him,” Adora said. “It wasn’t hard. She lies all the time.”

“Yeah, that’s true,” Catra said. “You could totally kick his ass anyway, *princess.*”

“Yeah, you’re probably right,” Adora said. “Let’s… *not* talk about that though.”

“Huh, why?”
“Just… being careful,” Adora said.

“Lord Hordak?” Adora entered the dark sanctum once again, her sword still firmly strapped to her back. “You wanted to see me?”

“I did.” Hordak stepped out of the shadows, the sickly green glow of his machines reflecting off his pale face. “I wanted to congratulate you, Force Captain.”

“For what?” Adora asked.

“On your promotion, of course,” Hordak said. “With the traitorous Shadow Weaver in a holding cell, I need someone to replace her, and I couldn’t think of anyone better than you.”

“Me?” Adora asked, shocked. “But I’ve been a force captain for, like, less than a week.”

“That may be true,” Hordak said. “But I require someone with raw power comparable to Shadow Weaver’s, or perhaps even exceeding hers; someone who is an army all onto themselves. You fit the bill perfectly, *She-Ra.*”

“My lord.” Adora kneeled before Hordak. “I’m honored to receive this, well, honor.”

“Words have never been your strong suit, have they, Force Captain?” Hordak said. “But forgive me, that is not relevant. Will you accept your new role in my empire? Do you choose to stand beside me as my right hand? Will you fight as the personified strength of the Horde?”

“Yes, my lord,” Adora said.

“Excellent,” Hordak said. “Then rise, She-Ra, Princess of Power, and let us lay waste to the Brightmoon rebellion, once and for all!”

Adora stood back up and looked at Hordak’s blood red eyes. She knew that, at some point, the two of them would have to come to blows, but now was not that time. For now, she was content to serve under him, so long as he allowed her the free reign she desired.

Chapter End Notes

Hi, thanks for reading!

I kind of wanted this end to be a parallel the end of season 1, where Hordak makes Catra his second-in-command, but this time with Adora. I'll start posting part two in a few weeks when I finish it, probably March. I'm planning for around thirteen chapters again, if not longer. Make sure that you're following me and not just this work so you get updated on that. Chapter 1 of that will be Princess Prom!

Comments are always appreciated!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!